David Ceraso – Portfolio Review

Prepared for Neha Singh

NETFLIX

What You’ll Hear Today

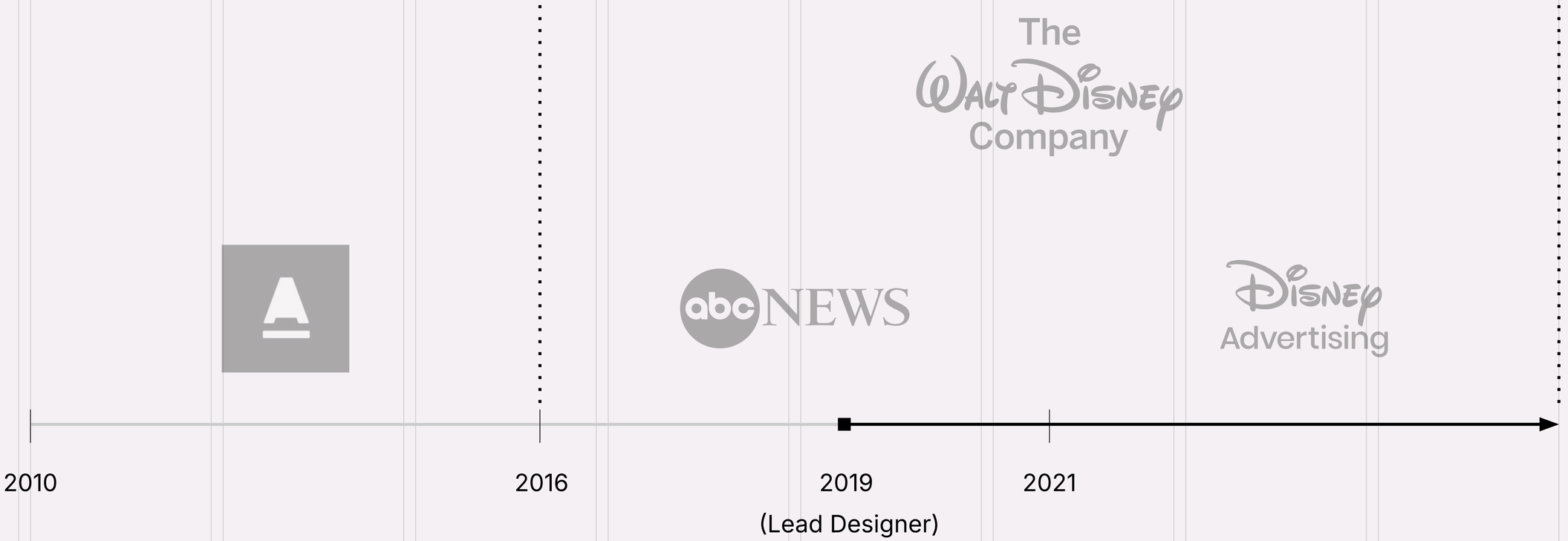
1 / Leadership Style

2 / Executive Presence

My Career


The
Walt Disney
Company
abc NEWS
Disney
Advertising
2010
2016
2021

People Management



Leadership Change



Leadership Change



Leadership Style

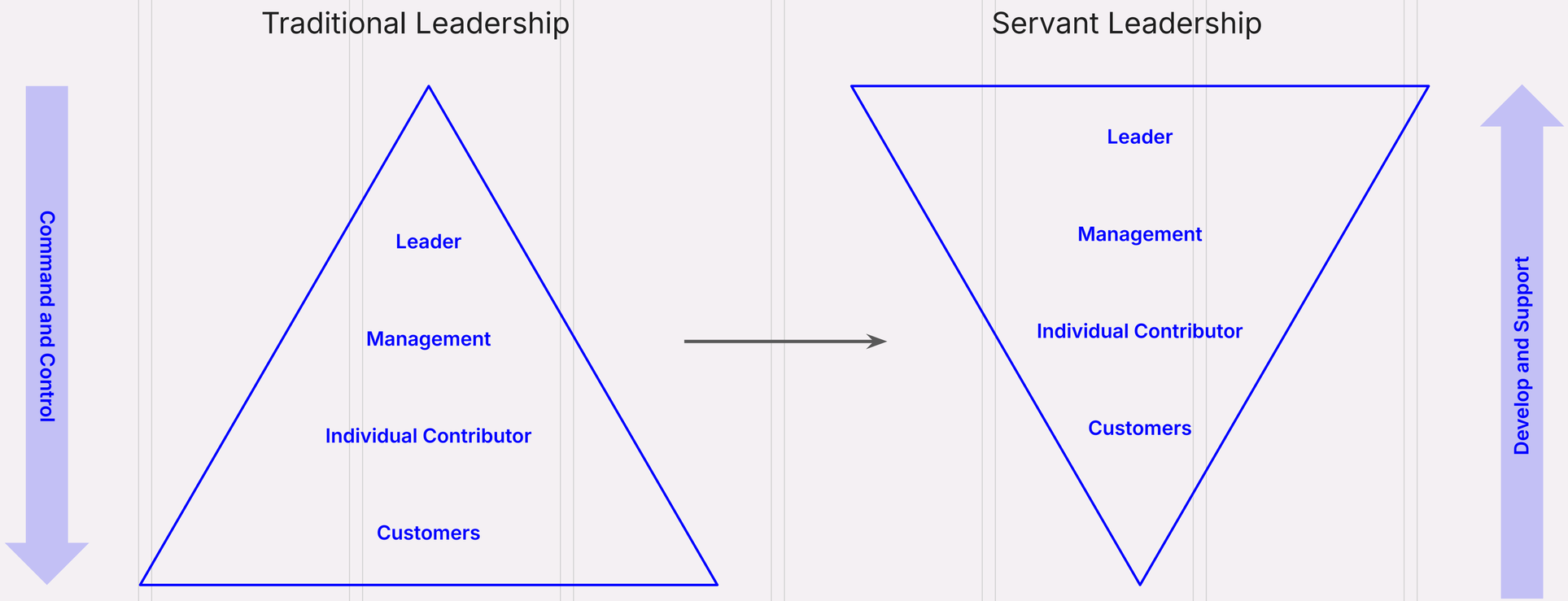


Michael Rawlins





Leadership Models



Servant Leadership

Benefits	Disadvantages
Better Teamwork & Collaboration	Slower decision-making
Positive Work Environment	Blurred authority
Reduced Turnover	Underperformance tolerance risk
Companies are Agile	Leader bandwidth strain
Improved Innovation	Harder to scale
Strong Culture	Inconsistent execution
Accelerated Learning	Difficult in crisis moments
Future Leaders Prepared	Leader influence diluted

Strengths-Based Leadership



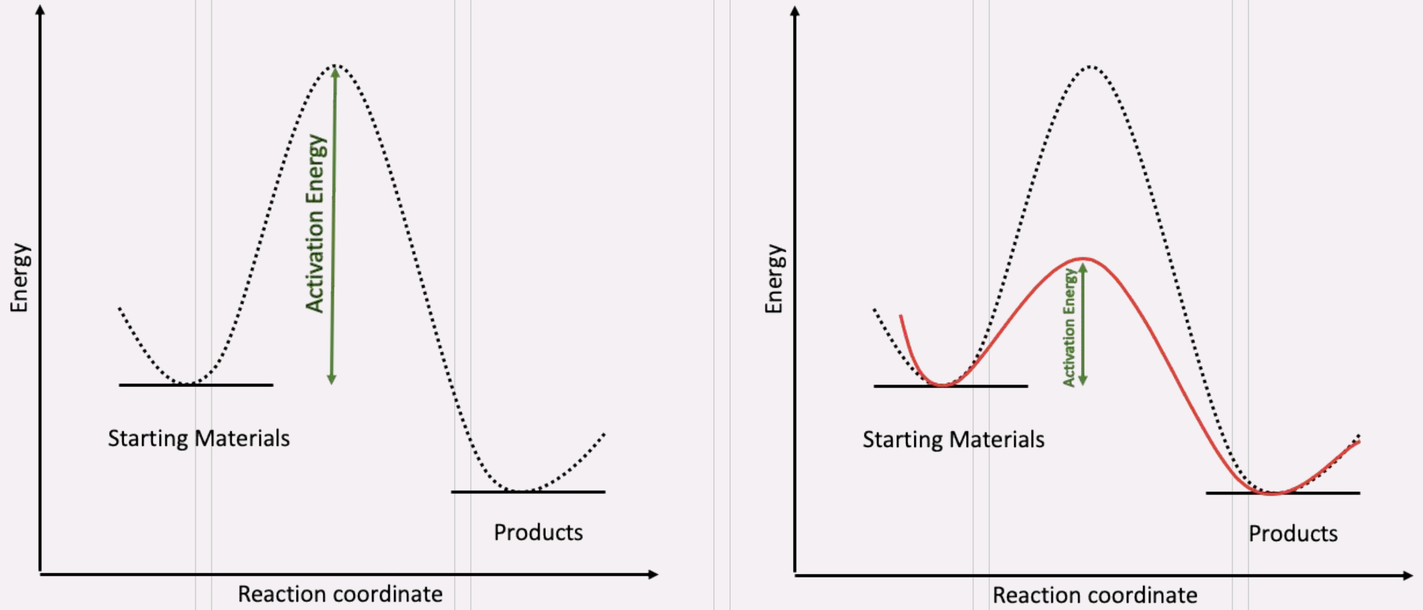
Philosophy



A manager's role is to reach inside and release the unique talents into performance.

Don’t try to change people. Focus on unlocking what makes them exceptional. One individual at a time.

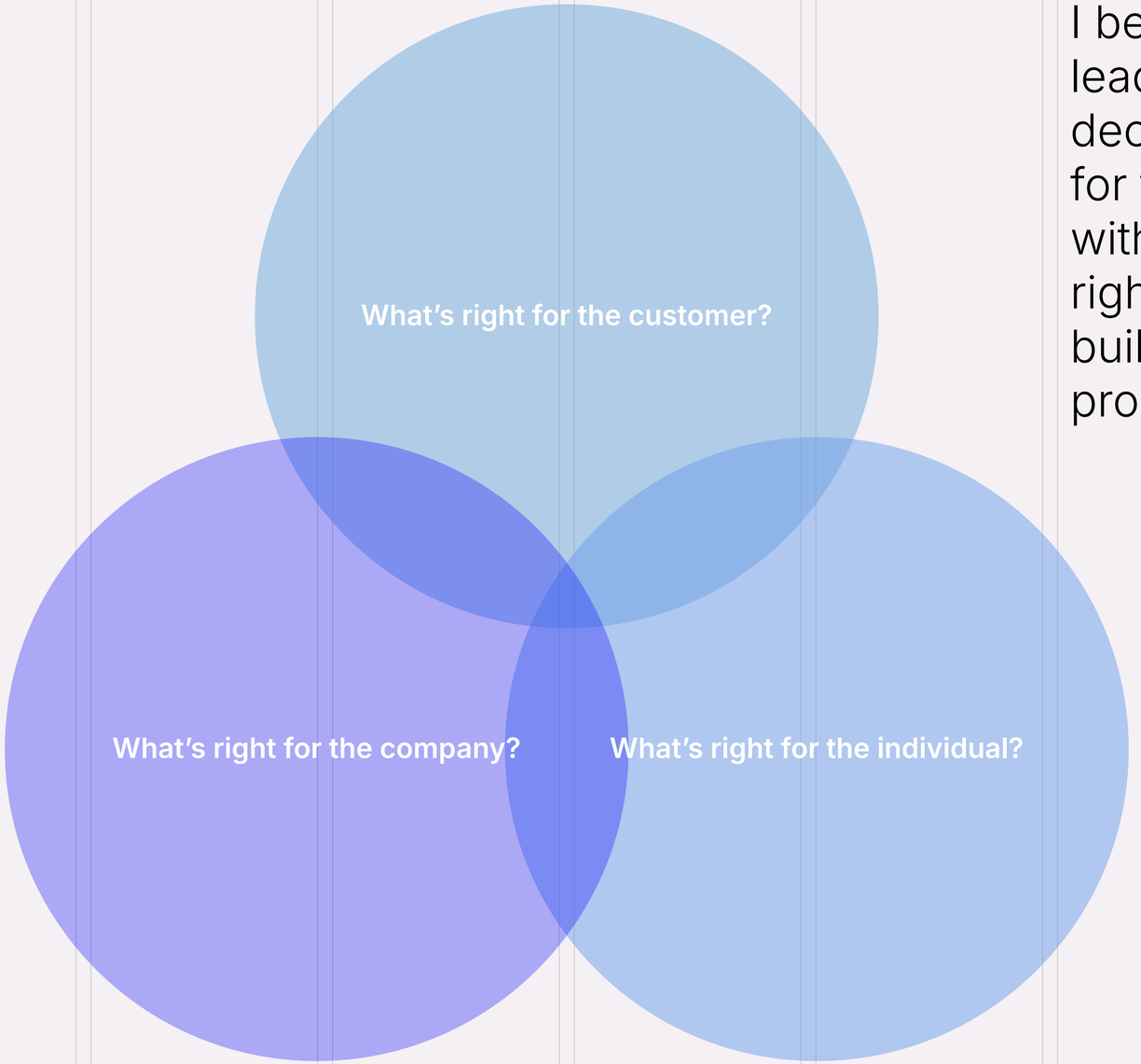
Catalysis



A catalyst is a substance that speeds up a chemical reaction, or lowers the temperature/pressure needed for it, without being consumed in the process

Leadership as creating the conditions where great work happens faster and more consistently.

Question of Balance



I believe a good leader makes decisions that work for the business without losing what’s right for the people building it in the process.

Blend of the Best Parts

- ➔ Remove friction so people can do their best work
- ➔ Invest time where it grows people, not just output
- ➔ Lead with empathy to understand what people truly need
- ➔ Design roles and work around individual strengths
- ➔ Scale strengths instead of fixing weaknesses
- ➔ Pay attention to what energizes vs. drains each person

My leadership style is grounded in a people-first approach. I serve each individual by building deep, authentic connections that allow me to truly understand what they do best, and I intentionally create the conditions for those strengths to drive meaningful impact.

Philosophy → Practice

Connection Evidence

- Zero attrition during high-change periods
- Strong trust through consistent 1:1s and coaching
- Designers step into expanded rolees, scope, and ownership

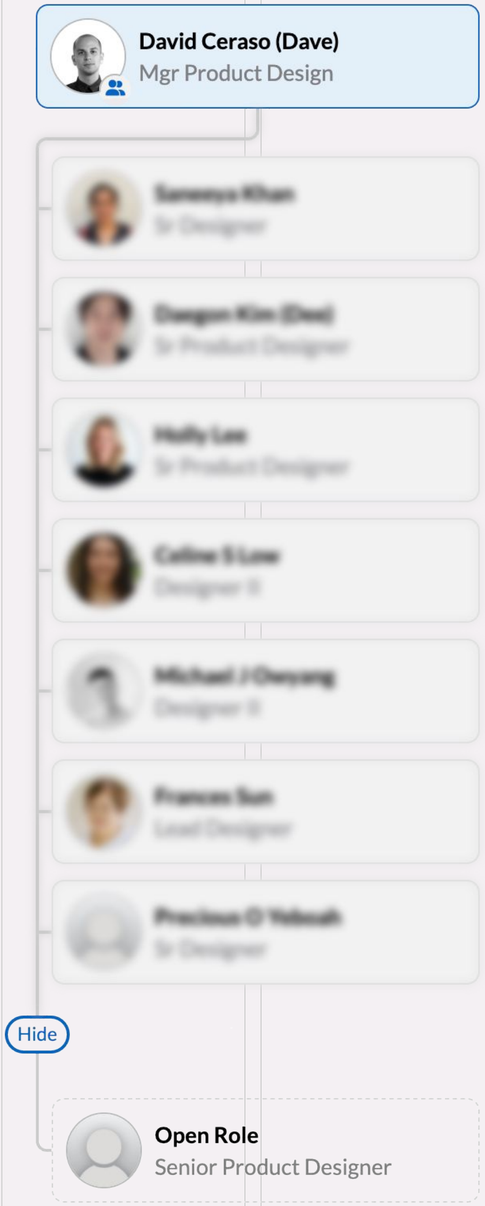
Strategy Evidence

- Strengths mapped across a 8+ designer team
- Talent aligned to critical roadmap priorities
- P3s elevated into high-impact platform work

Execution Evidence

- Strength-aligned ownership drives higher velocity
- High standards maintained without micromanagement
- Friction removed to enable focused, outcome-driven delivery

My Team


David Ceraso (Dave)
Mgr Product Design
Hide
Open Role
Senior Product Designer

My “AFS” Scope

Automated Marketplaces						Mission Control + Core Ad Serving						Data + BI		Quote-to-Cash										
Rocket	**Groot**	**Tam's Squad**	**Externalization Team 1 (Gamora)**	**Externalization Team 2 (Starlord)**	**Externalization Team 3 (Nebula)**	**Katana**	**Spear**	**Arrow**	**DanAds**	**Koala**	**Koala**	N/A	Ramy Dihom	**Ad Technology Integration**	**SF-Avatar**	**SF-Nemo**	**SF-Soarin**	**OMS Team 1 (Planning Admin Suite)**	**Foundational API**	**OMS Team 3 (OMS Core Planning)**	**OMS Team 4 (OMS Foundational Services)**	**OMS Team 5 (Jarvis)**	**OMS Operative**	**Harps Web**	**Harps ETL**	**AdValue (formerly DCM)**
Squad responsible for mid-lower funnel DCM features including pricing, audiences, targeting, inventory packages, and coupons	Squad responsible for DCM API integrations with 3rd party buying systems	Align across DCM	Squad responsible for creative management and advanced ad formats in DCM	Squad responsible for top funnel DCM features including email messaging, notifications, onboarding flow, and accounts	Squad responsible for full funnel insights, instrumentation, optimization, and DCM experimentation	Trafficking MC	Targeting ALM/IRM	Policy & Supply Management, MC strategy	Flow over squad that can work on any feature. In partnership with third-party engineering team DanAds	Squad responsible to design and implement tools used for DAS troublehooting and partner split configurations. This is a common tool used for VOD and Live DAS flows.	Squad responsible to design and implement tools used for DAS troublehooting and partner split configurations. This is a common tool used for VOD and Live DAS flows.	Dave Vendetto	Neal Zhang	Squad focused on the integration for Ad Technology Systems between Salesforce, AdVisor, Content Scheduler, M360, GripIt & Media Engineering	Salesforce squad responsible for the creation of cross-platform Salesforce Analytics & Reporting dashboards	Salesforce squad responsible for unifying all features for self-service and marketing capabilities onto the SalesHub platform, and deprecation of the legacy Huluforce platform	Salesforce squad responsible for supporting the unified Salesforce platform, upfront tool enhancements and onboarding of Disney ad sales business units	OMS squad responsible for User Management, Roles and Permissions, Personalization, Workflows, Messaging and Notification Center, Error Handling, Operational Reporting	OMS squad responsible for Internal API (IFP, HARPS, Rate Card, ODS, Targeting Manager, AI/ML Service), External API (DCM, Third-Party API Partnerships)	OMS squad responsible for Planning, Order Headers, Media Plan Creation, Add Line Items and Targeting to Plan, Saleshub Integration, Mission Control Integration	OMS squad responsible for Inventory Management (Selling Titles, Title Bundles/Packages), Targeting Management (CRUD), Campaign Orchestrator, Customer Manager (DCM SH Update)	OMS squad responsible for developing the Chat-Bot and agents to support the retrieval-based data providers	Current state Product Managent and Configuration of Addressable Planning and OMS through the Operative.One product	Squad responsible for supporting the Web development for HARPS, the in-house Disney advertising revenue, invoice and payment platform	Squad responsible for supporting the ETL development for HARPS, the in-house Disney advertising revenue, invoice and payment platform	Squad working to build enhanced Payments and Invoicing for Disney "PaID"
												NA	NA													
												Danny Huang	Danny Huang													
												ODS Core	ODS Metrics/Metadata													
												Squad responsible for building a highly scalable, highly lean, and cost-effective event data platform and offline data applications centralized on the ODS to enable billing, offline analytics, optimization, data integration and other data-driven business operations	Squad responsible for building real time operational data services and data products on top of ODS to provide real time data access and enable online analytics capabilities for troubleshooting and monitoring													
David Gash	Carlos Valiente		Jacqueline Chao	Carlos Valiente	Lana Nguyen	John McNicolas	Tony Chaw	Elizabeth Phan	Brian Laton	Omar Salix	Omar Salix			Dan Garaffa	Vanessa Mensah	Lamiya Vanasuva	Tatiana Lazebnyk	Ritchie Kovak (same as OMS team 3)	TBH	Ritchie Kovak	Adam Hecht	Alexis Presbrey	Abraham Martinez	Lani Li/Dominick Battiato	Lani Li/Dominick Battiato	Mahi Chowdhury
Chandler Warne	Hao Yan		TBD	TBD	TBD	David Jimenez	David Jimenez	Junaid Najeeb	?	Sky Lin	Sky Lin			Tashani Kathiarsacchi	Tulasi Agina	Aman Sharma	Tia Xuan	TBH	TBH	TBH	TBH	TBH		Samuel Choi	Mariano Hernandez	Ving Trung
Dee Kim	Dee Kim	Dee Kim	Precious Yeboah	Precious Yeboah	Precious Yeboah	Celine Low	Saneeya Khan	Saneeya Khan	Saneeya Khan	Saneeya Khan	Saneeya Khan	N/A	Dennis Hou, Shailender Ann	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	Frances Sun	NA	Frances Sun (lead) Michael Owyang (future)	Holly Priest	Michael Owyang	NA	Frances Sun	NA	NA

My Product Scope

PITCH		PLAN		TRAFFIC		PAY
Sales Channels	CRM	Audience Forecasting	Planning & OMS	Campaign Mgmt.	Ad Decisioning	Revenue, Billing
Direct Sold	salesforce	Inventory Forecasting Platform (IFP)	Order Management System (Atlas)	Mission Control	Disney Ad Server	HARPS
Self-Service				Campaign Manager		
Programmatic					DRAX	PAID

Measurement	Disney COMPASS
Reporting	
Data	Operational Data Store (ODS)

Case Study 2

Disney Campaign Manager – Externalization

Executive Leadership OKRs



Be CTV's Highest Yield Platform

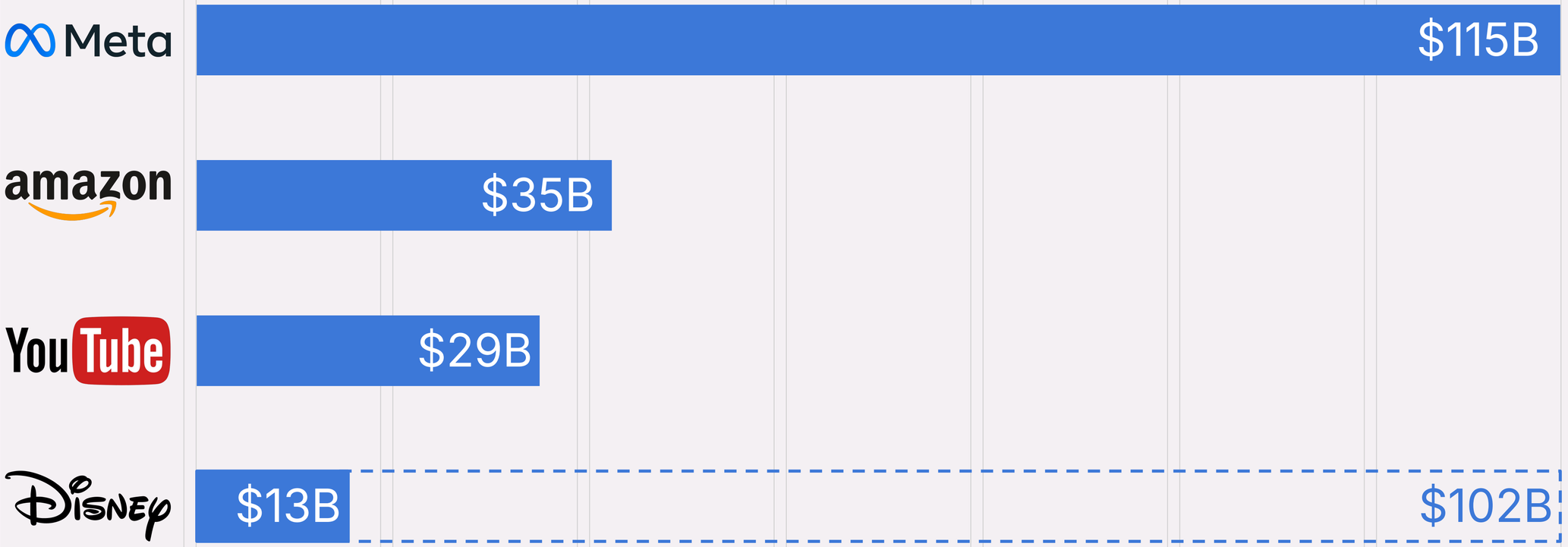
Be the Easiest Buying Platform to Transact With

Generate the Industry's Greatest Value for Advertisers

Disney's Competition

Company	DTC Inventory	Ad Platform	Global Ad Revenue
Meta	Facebook Watch, Instagram	Meta for Business	$115.0B
amazon	IMDb, fire tv, twitch	amazon advertising	$35.9B *Includes search
Google	YouTube, YouTube TV	YouTube	$29.9B *Excludes search
COMCAST	peacock	FREEWHEEL A COMCAST COMPANY	$15.7B
The Walt Disney Company	hulu, ESPN+, Disney+	Disney Ad Server, Google Ad Manager For ESPN+	$13.1B
Paramount	Paramount+, pluto tv	Google Ad Manager	$11.1B
WARNER BROS. DISCOVERY	discovery+, HBO max	FREEWHEEL A COMCAST COMPANY	$10.4B
NETFLIX	NETFLIX	Microsoft	N/A

The Gap (Global Ad Revenue)

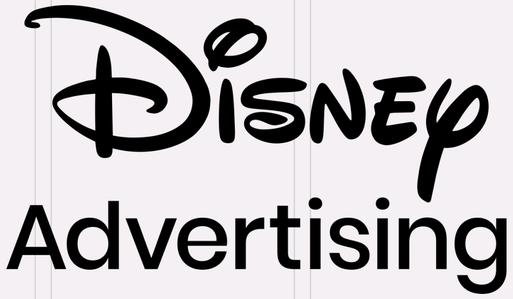


Problem Statement

How do we close the gap? How do we compete more directly and substantially with Meta, Amazon, Google?


BAIN & COMPANY

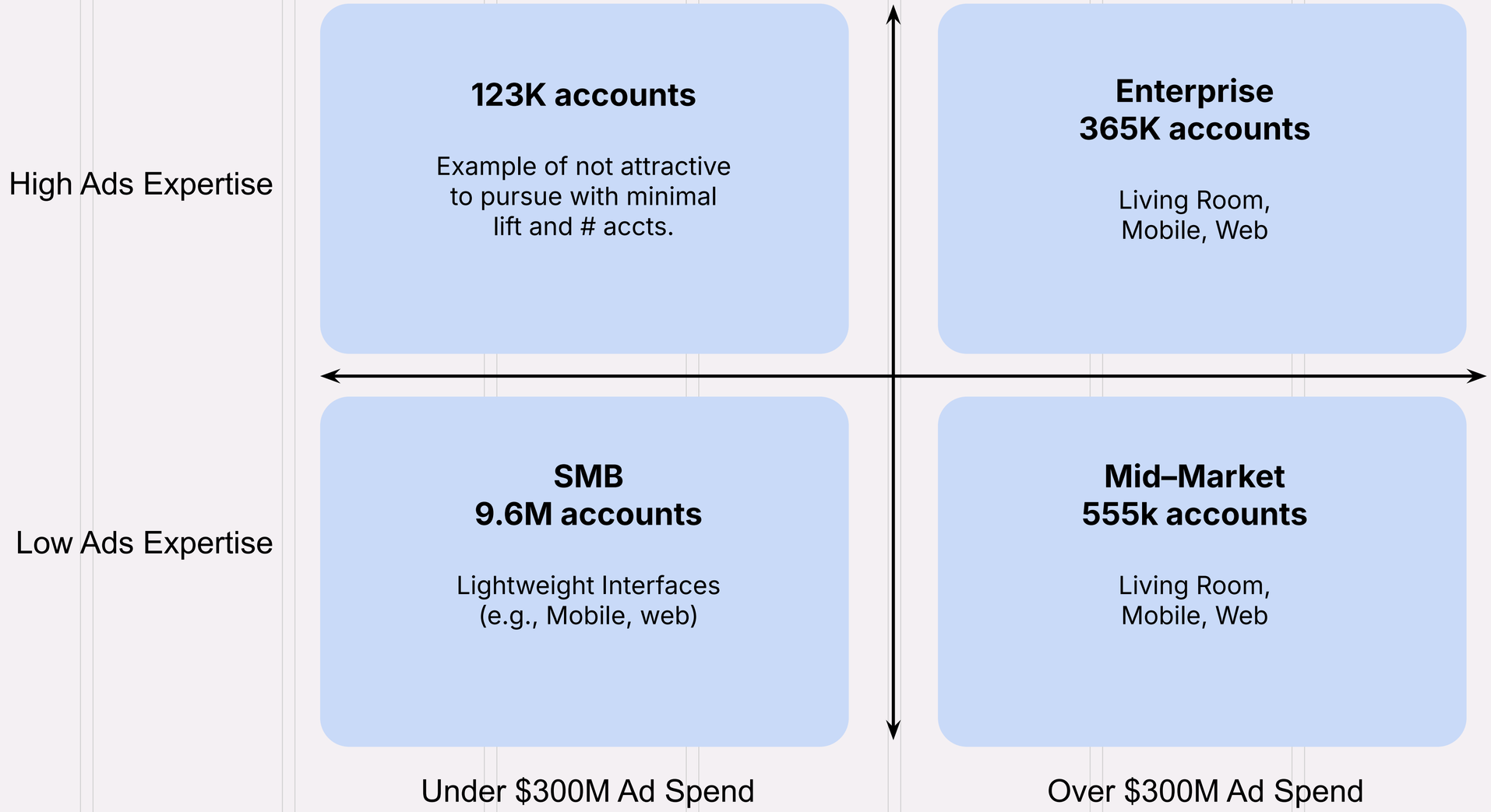
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Disney
Advertising

Who Advertises With Us?

Type of Organization	Number of Employees	Annual Revenue	Ex.
Small Business	Up to 100 employees	Up to $50 million	BOB JOHNSON TOYOTA
Mid-Market Business	100-999 employees	$50 million - $1 billion	CUSTOM INK
Enterprise	1000+ employees	More than $1 billion	Coca-Cola

Where is there opportunity?



Where is there opportunity?

High Ads Expertise

Low Ads Expertise

123K accounts

Example of not attractive to pursue with minimal lift and # accts.

Enterprise
365K accounts

Living Room, Mobile, Web

SMB
9.6M accounts

Lightweight Interfaces (e.g., Mobile, web)

Mid–Market
555k accounts

The top 17% of Mid-Market advertisers drive 50% of net total revenues

Under $300M Ad Spend

Over $300M Ad Spend

Mid-Market Advertiser Needs

	Efficient Upstart	Experienced Optimizer	Brand Builder	Incumbent Regional Brand	Incumbent National Brand
Example Companies	James Allen, AG1	Custom Ink, Playtika	NOOM, grammarly	Bob's Discount Furniture, Wegmans	ACE Hardware, Kraft Heinz
Primary Needs	Creative Composition Tooling Advanced targeting (e.g., behavioral segments) 'Live' performance reporting, insights	Incrementality across channels (e.g., proof via MMM or MTA) Clean rooms for buying Advanced reporting/data exporting	Audience creation/reach Creative Composition / Optimization Tooling Insights/support (new to video channels)	Local market targeting (both on geo and loyalty data) Relevance in local market Plugins for agency reporting solutions (or agency use of reporting)	Audience reach Exclusive placements Agency data plugins for cross channel measurement Clean rooms for buying

Theme: Publisher-Controlled → Advertiser-Controlled

Access to Measurement & Performance

- Advanced reporting / data exporting
- Cross-channel measurement plugins
- “Live” performance reporting
- Insights / support

Audience Targeting Controls & Reach

- Advanced targeting (behavioral segments)
- Audience creation
- 1P data activation inside the platform
- Direct control over geo + loyalty targeting

Creative & Optimization Tooling

- Creative composition tooling
- “Off-the-shelf” recommendations
- Collaboration on campaign strategy
- Immediate budget and creative adjustments

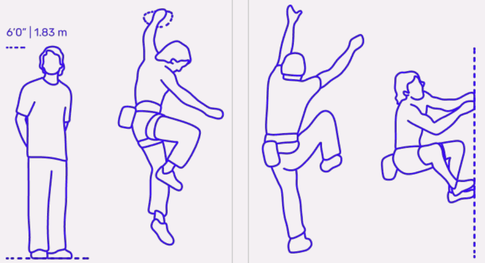
Hypothesis

We must transform from a managed media seller into an advertiser-controlled growth platform.

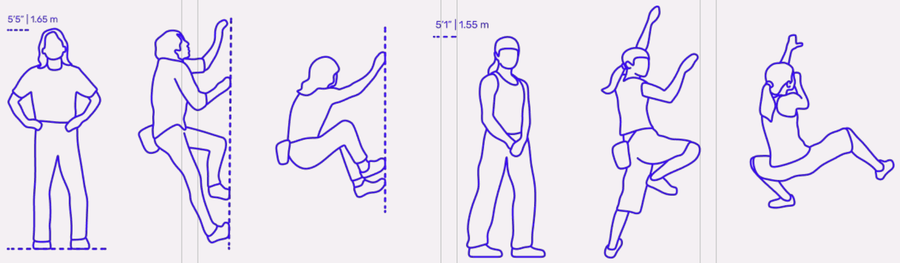
We must transfer power, control, data, and optimization directly to the advertiser.

User Journeys

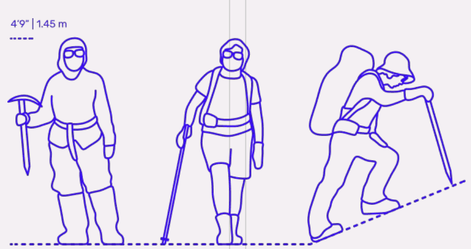
Small-Medium

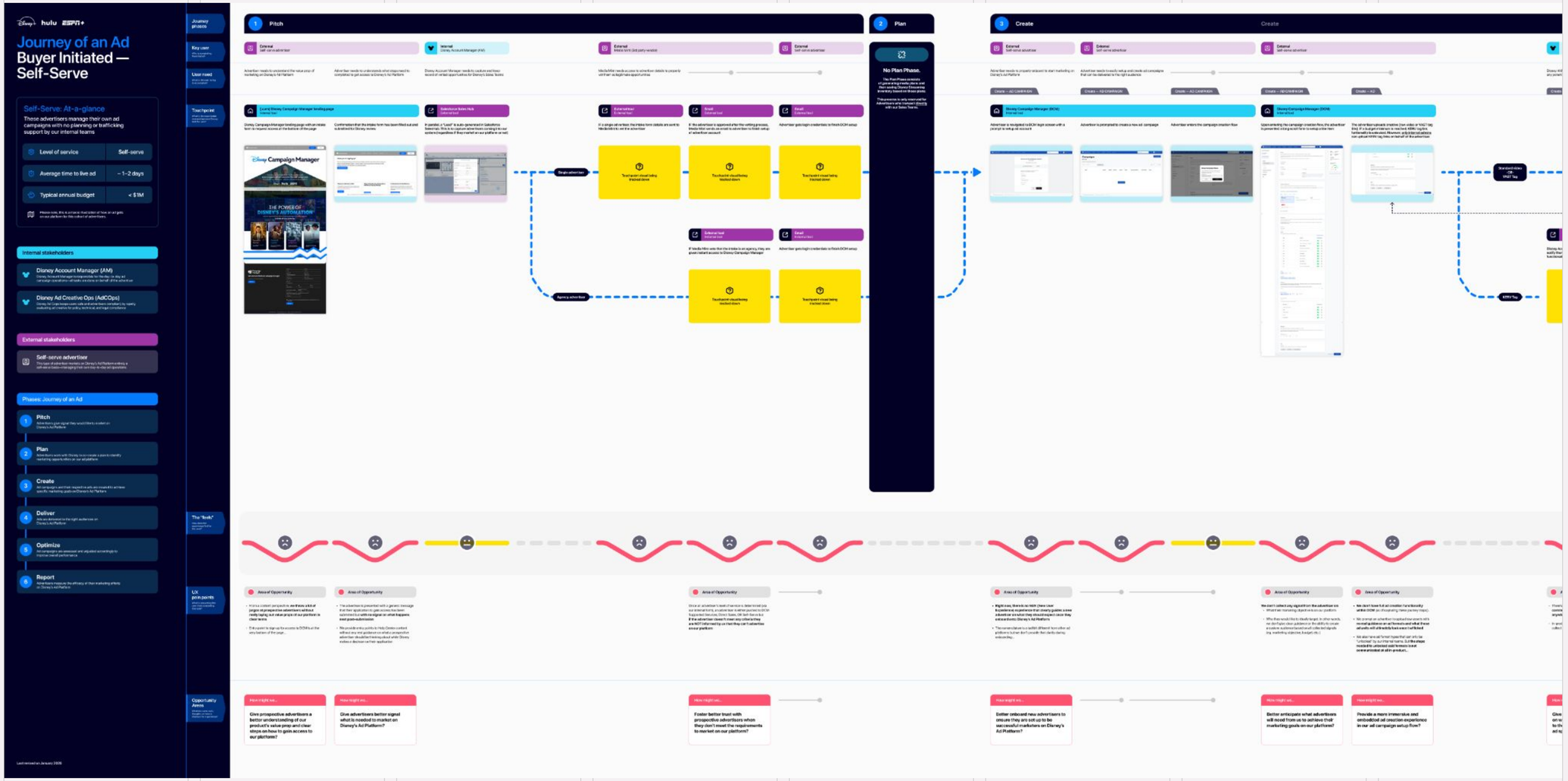


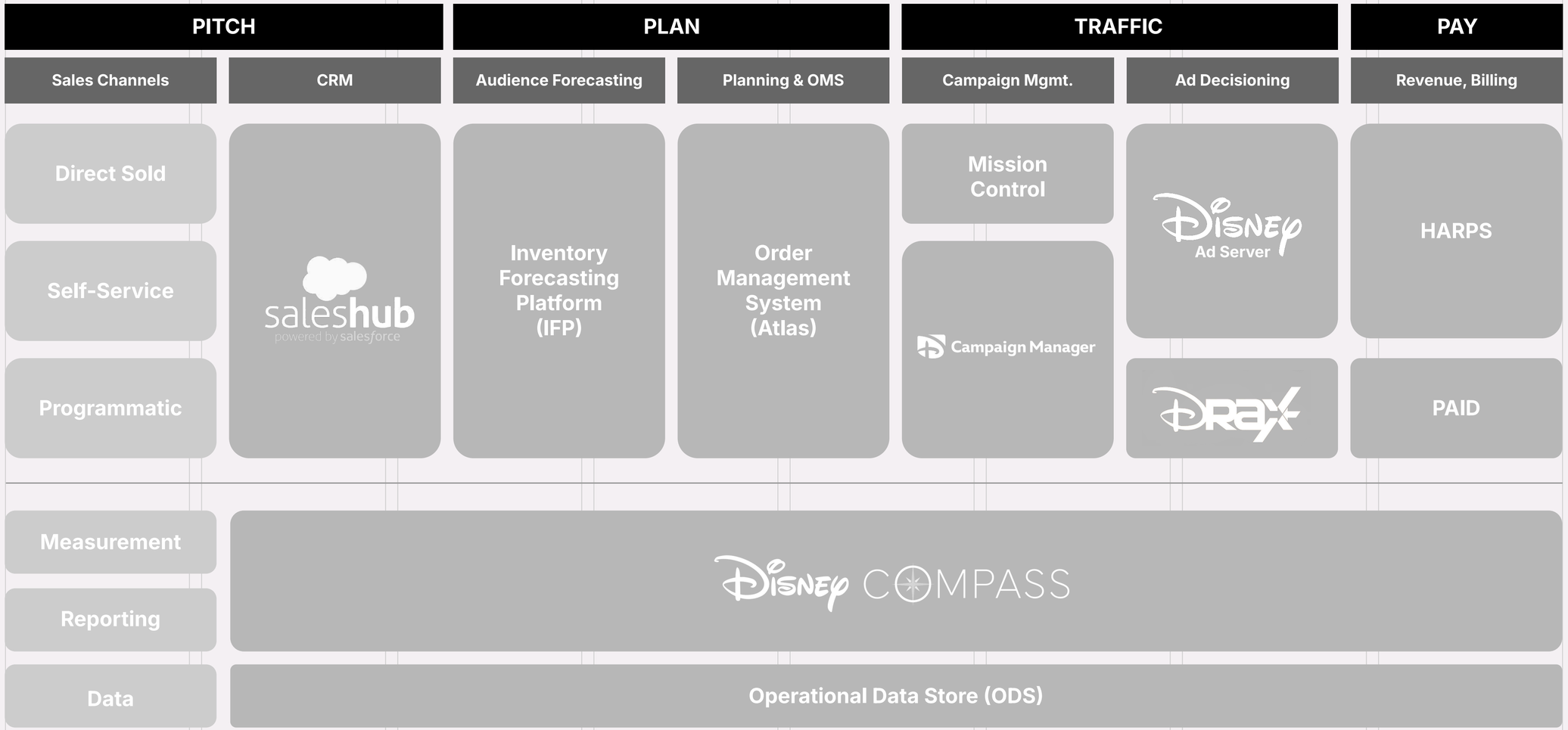
Mid-Market



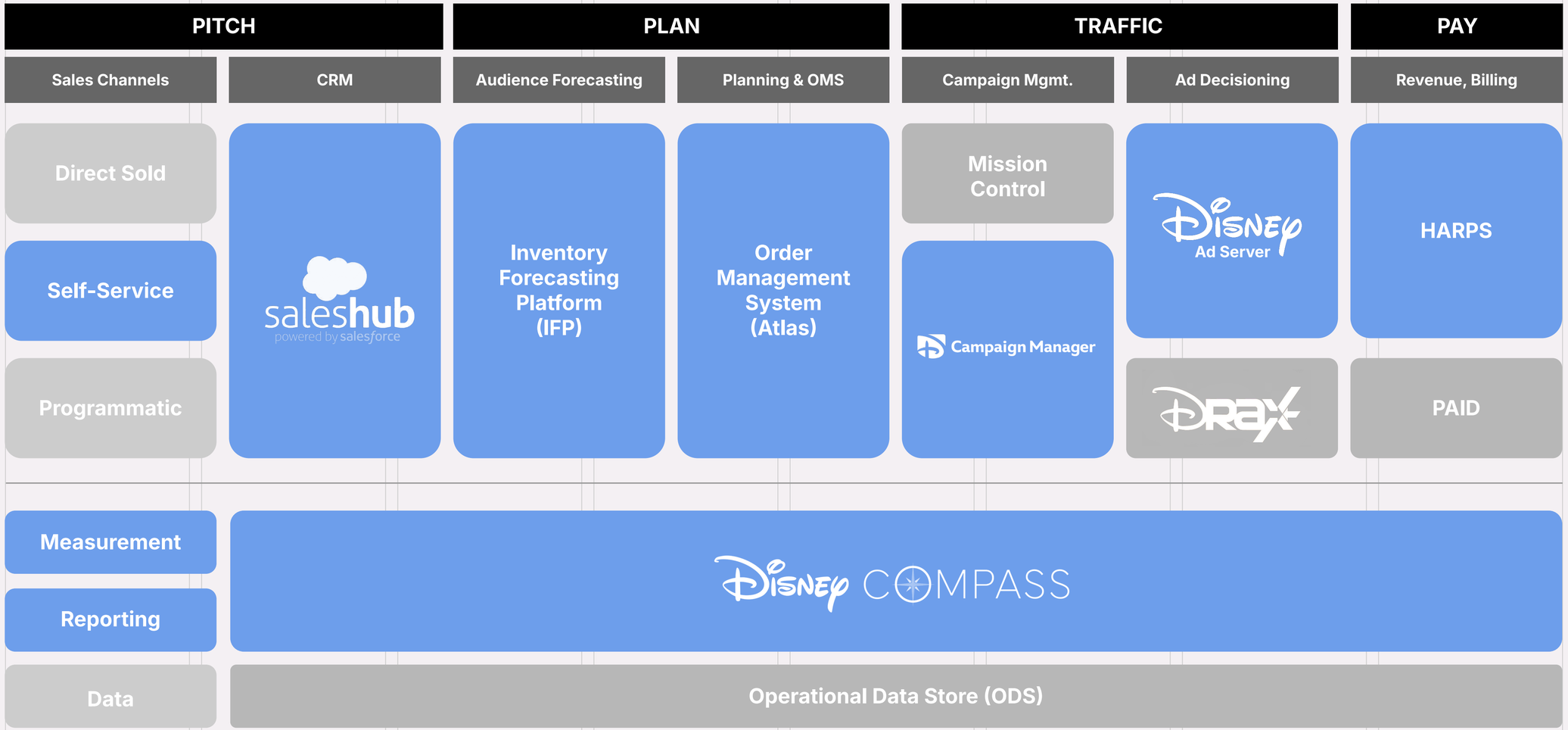
Enterprise




Journey of an Ad
Buyer Initiated —
Self-Serve
Self-Serve: At-a-glance
Level of service
Self-serve
Average time to live ad
~ 1–2 days
Typical annual budget
< $1M
Internal stakeholders
Disney Account Manager (AM)
Disney Ad Creative Ops (AdCOps)
External stakeholders
Self-serve advertiser
Phases: Journey of an Ad
1 Pitch
2 Plan
3 Create
4 Deliver
5 Optimize
6 Report
Journey phases
Key user
User need
Touchpoint
The "feels"
UX pain points
Opportunity Areas
1 Pitch
2 Plan
No Plan Phase.
3 Create
Create
Campaign Manager
Single advertiser
Agency advertiser
Standard video OR VAST tag
KPM Tag
Area of Opportunity
Give prospective advertisers a better understanding of our product's value prop and clear steps on how to gain access to our platform?
Give advertisers better signal what is needed to market on Disney's Ad Platform?
Foster better trust with prospective advertisers whom they don't meet the requirements to market on our platform?
Better onboard new advertisers to ensure they are set up to be successful marketers on Disney's Ad Platform?
Better anticipate what advertisers will need from us to achieve their marketing goals on our platform?
Provide a more immersive and embedded ad creation experience in our ad campaign setup flow?


PITCH
PLAN
TRAFFIC
PAY
Sales Channels
CRM
Audience Forecasting
Planning & OMS
Campaign Mgmt.
Ad Decisioning
Revenue, Billing
Direct Sold
Self-Service
Programmatic
saleshub
powered by salesforce
Inventory Forecasting Platform (IFP)
Order Management System (Atlas)
Mission Control
Campaign Manager
Disney Ad Server
DRAX
HARPS
PAID
Measurement
Reporting
Data
Disney COMPASS
Operational Data Store (ODS)

Mid-Market Buys Self-Service

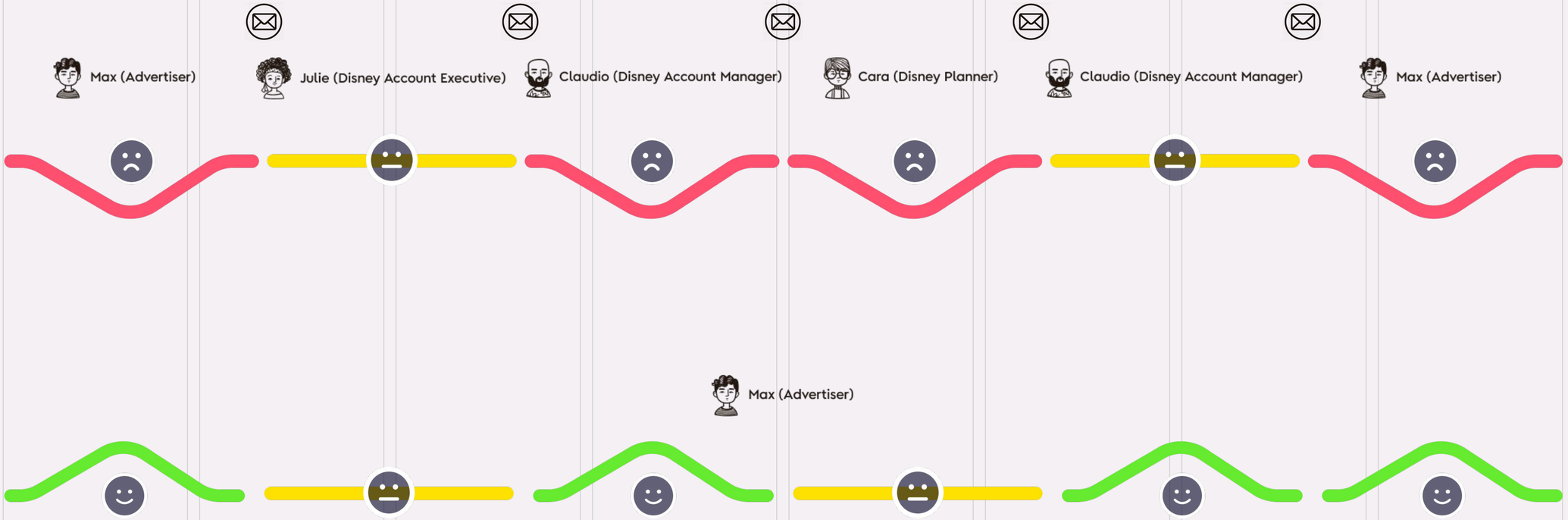


Advertisers expect one destination for ads.

Buying + Managing + Creation + Reporting – Unified

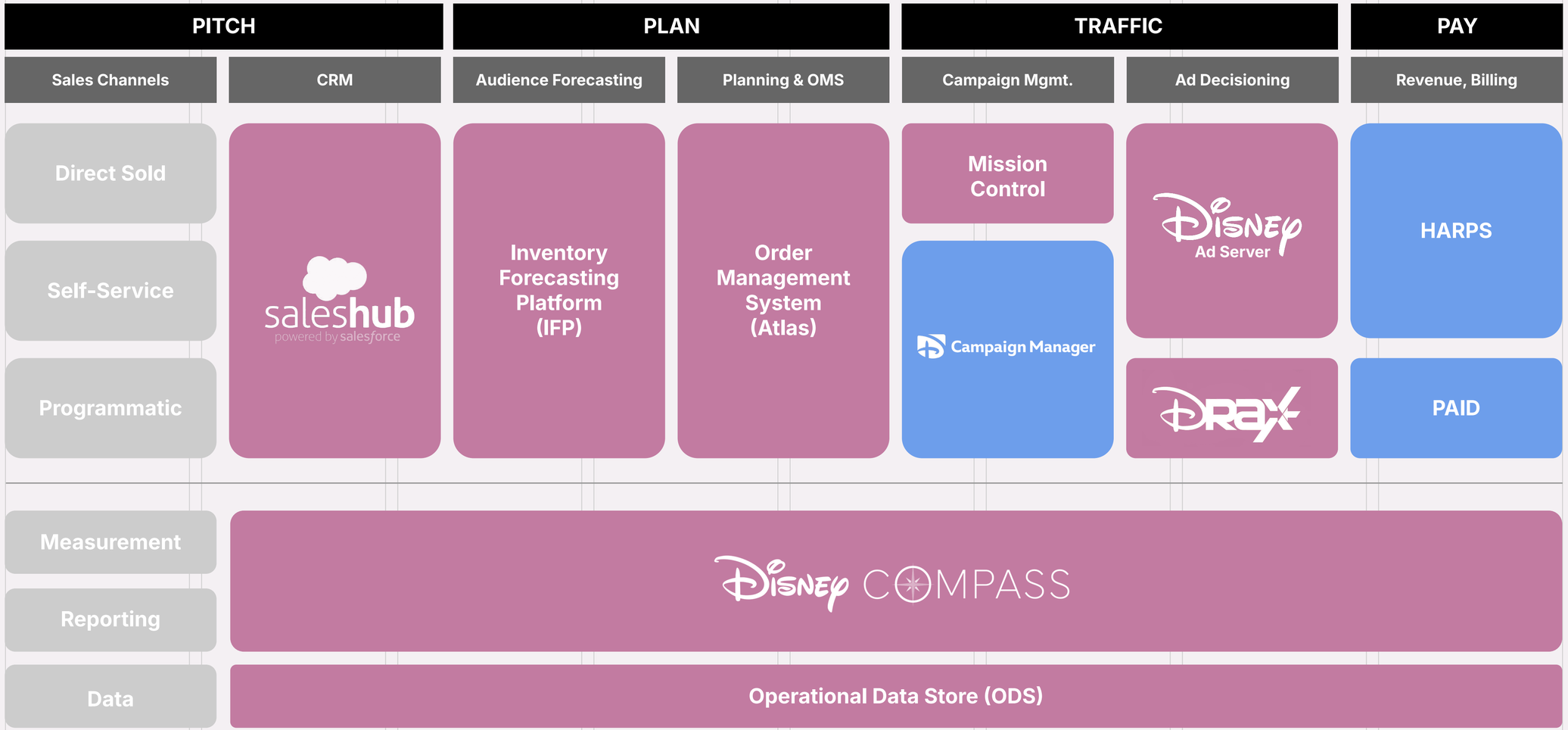
YouTube · Meta · Spotify · amazon ads · Roku · tubi · TikTok · peacock

Inefficiencies for Mid-Market



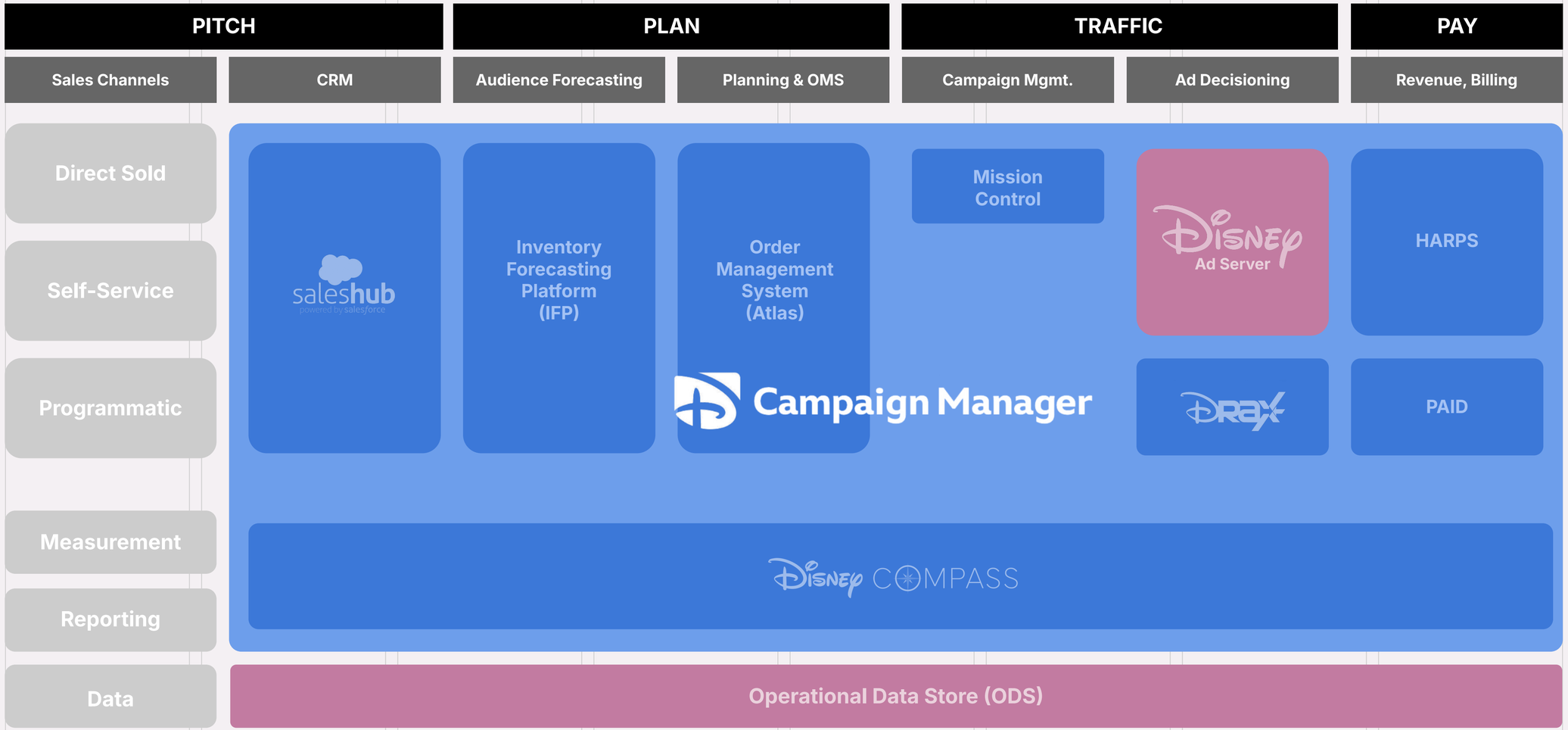
Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

External Tooling (Customer Facing)



Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

External Tooling (Customer Facing)



“Externalization”

Plan To Accelerate Mid-Market Ad Spend

Externalization of “Managed” Service

To achieve our aggressive goals and increase average mid-market spend, we must fully commit to transitioning traditional direct-sold workflows to DCM

Parity Features

Advanced Ads on DCM

Released: FY25 Q3

Content Packaging & Merchandising

Released: FY25 Q4

Introduce Desired Toolset to Mid-Market Buyers

Introduction of Advanced Targeting/Audience Creation, Interactive Creative Composition, and Creative Optimization will permit Objective Based Buying and unlock budgets

Data Activation & Measurement

Advanced Targeting & Audience Creation

Release: FY26 Q3

Self-Service Measurement and Data Onboarding

Release: FY26 Q4

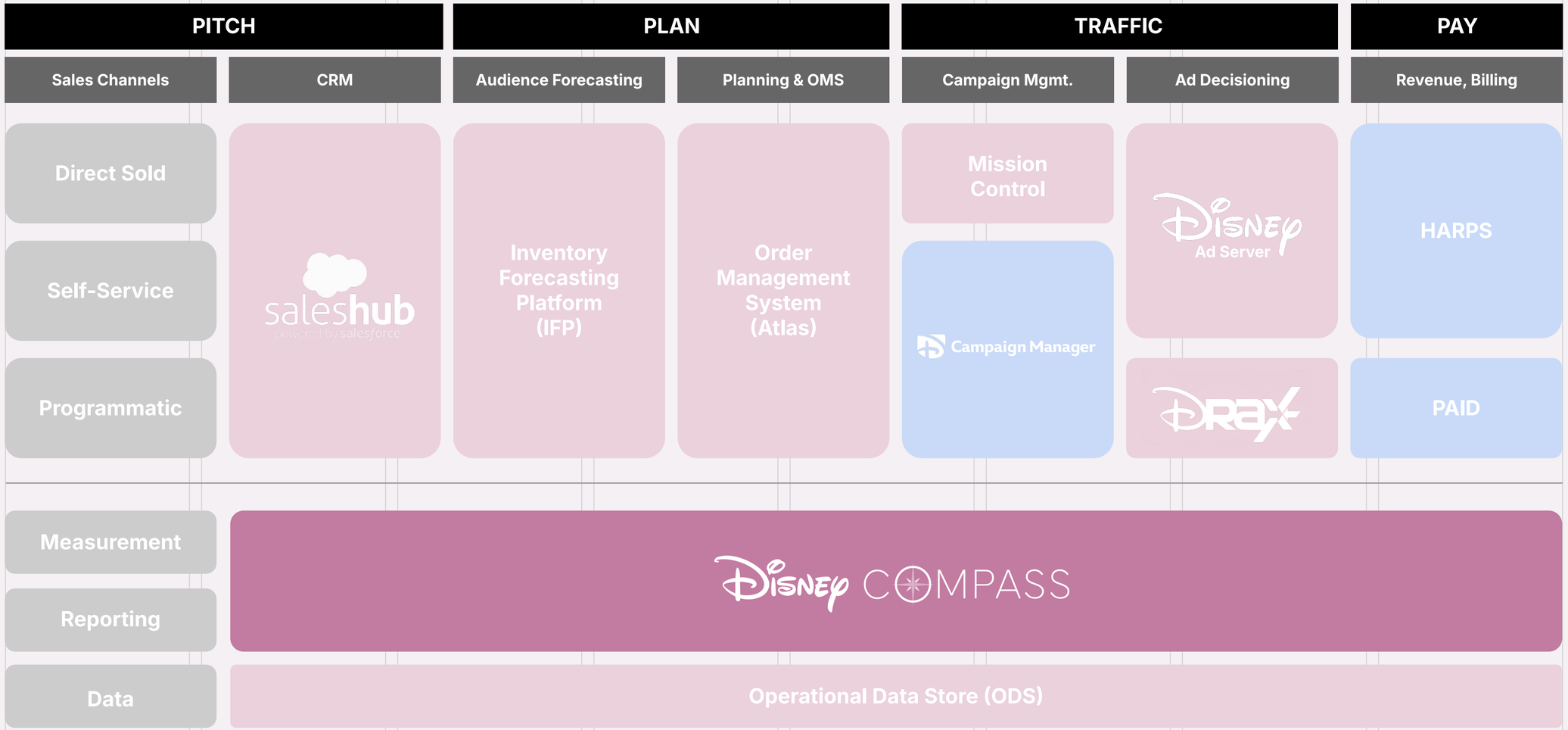
Disney eXperience Composer on DCM

DXC on DCM Enablement

Release: FY26 Q2

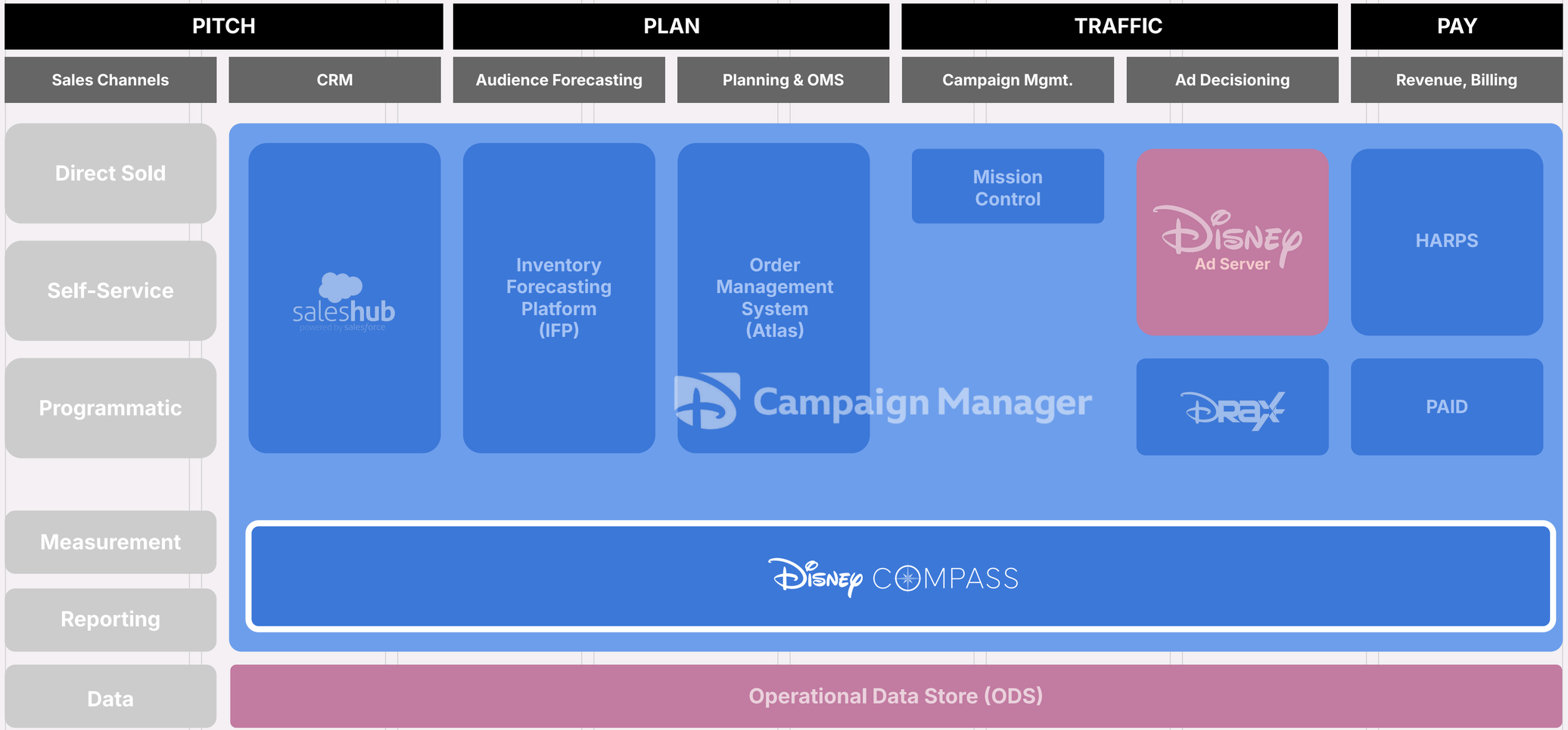
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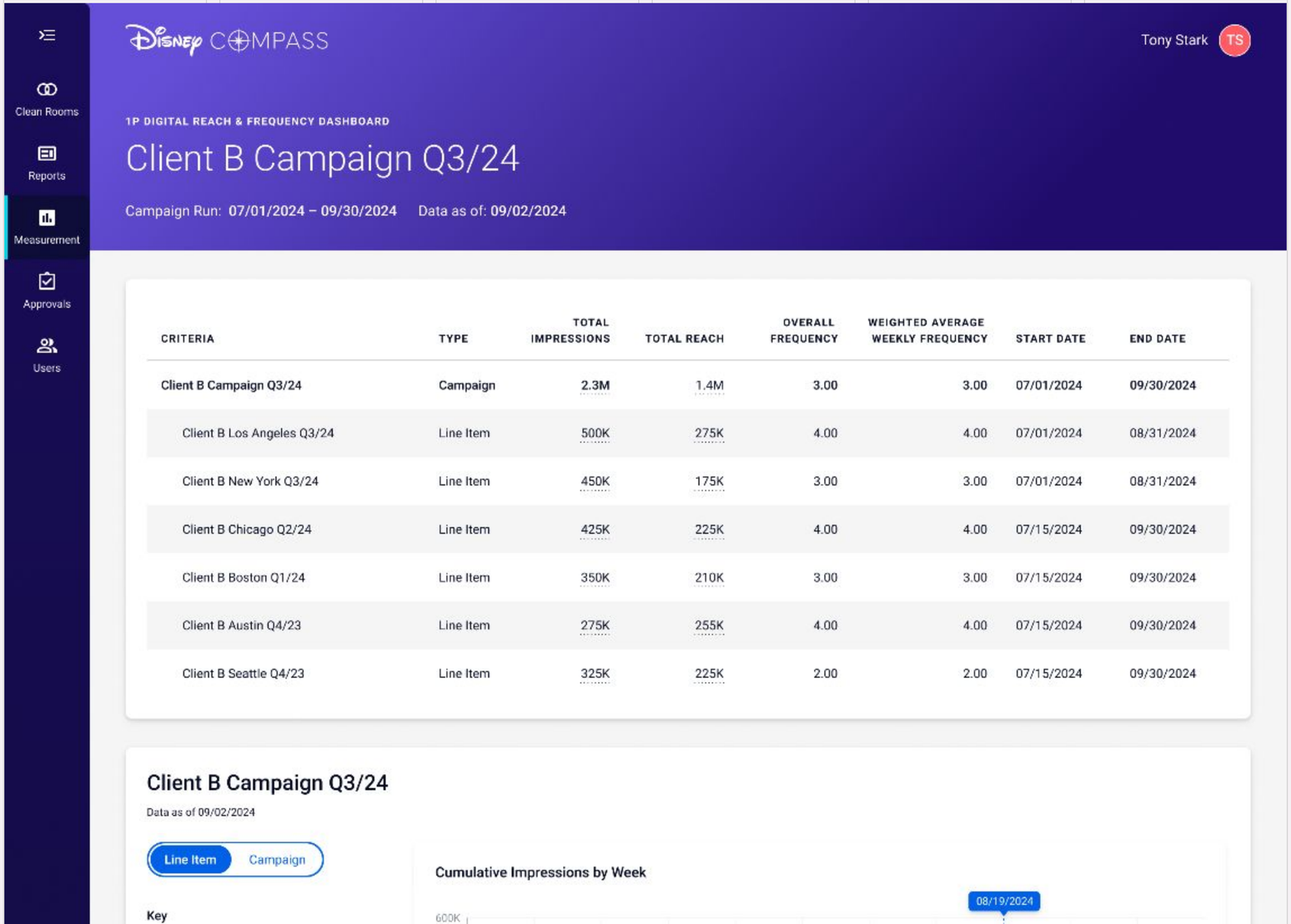


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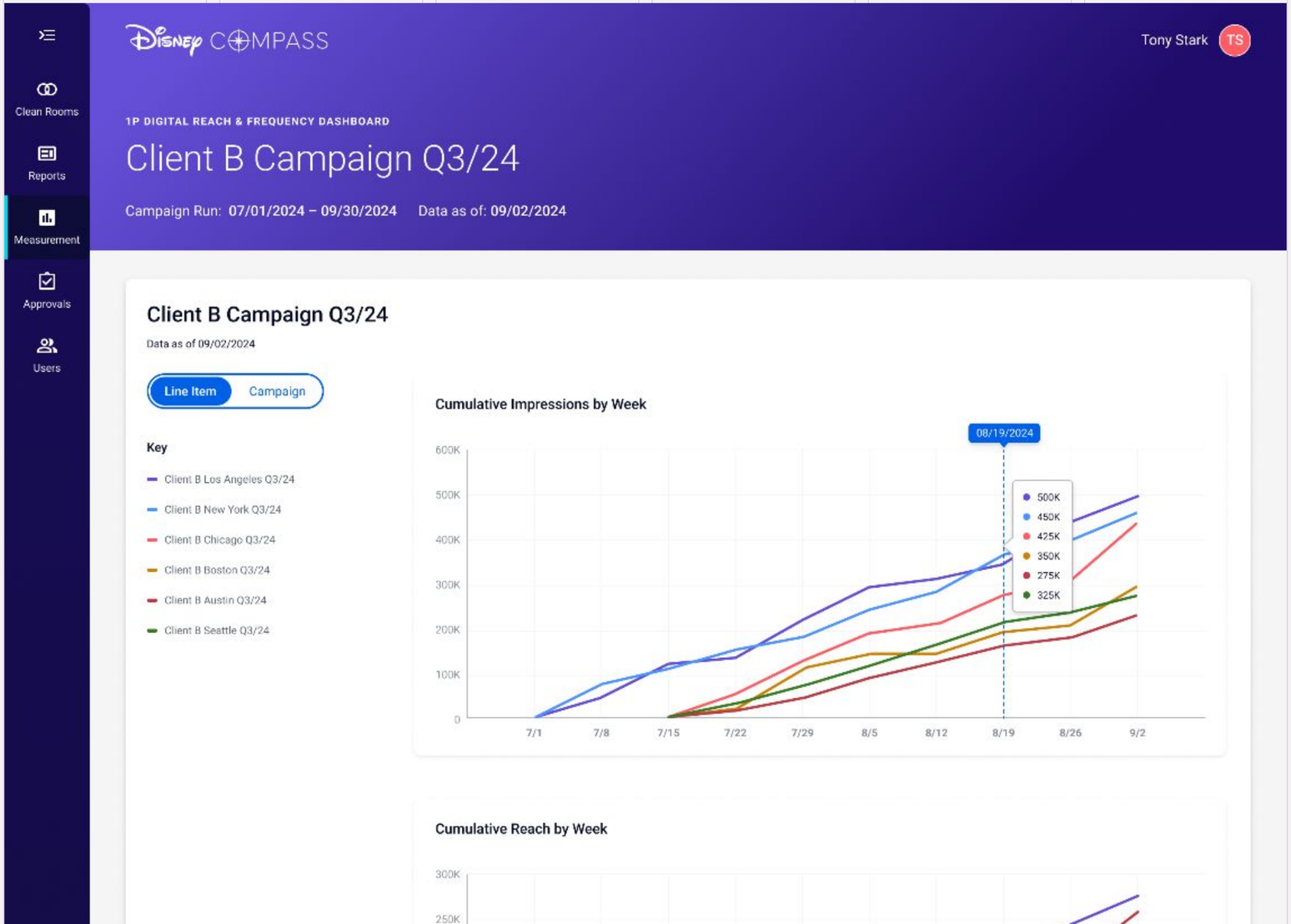
External Tooling (Customer Facing)



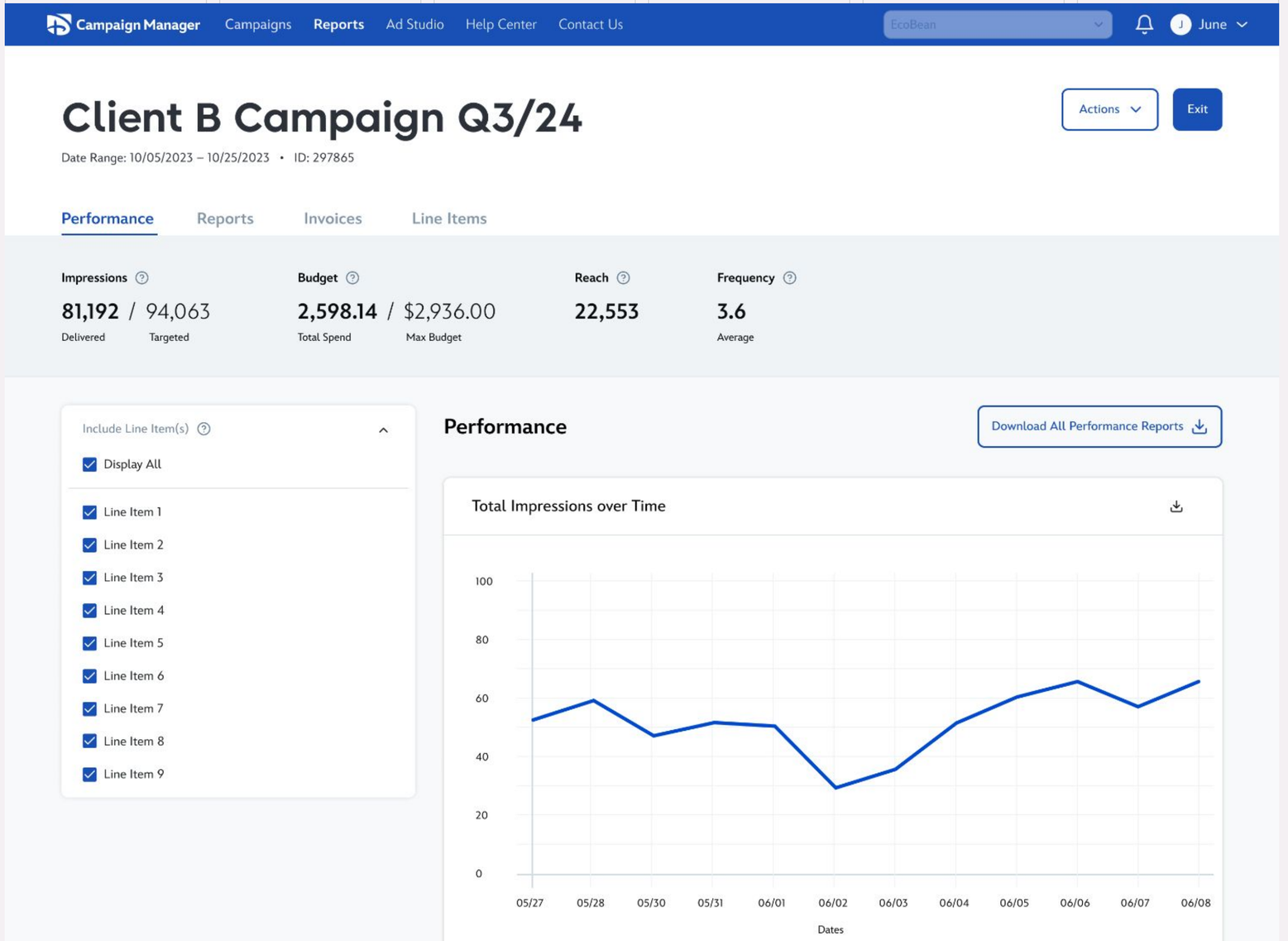
Existing Internal Reporting



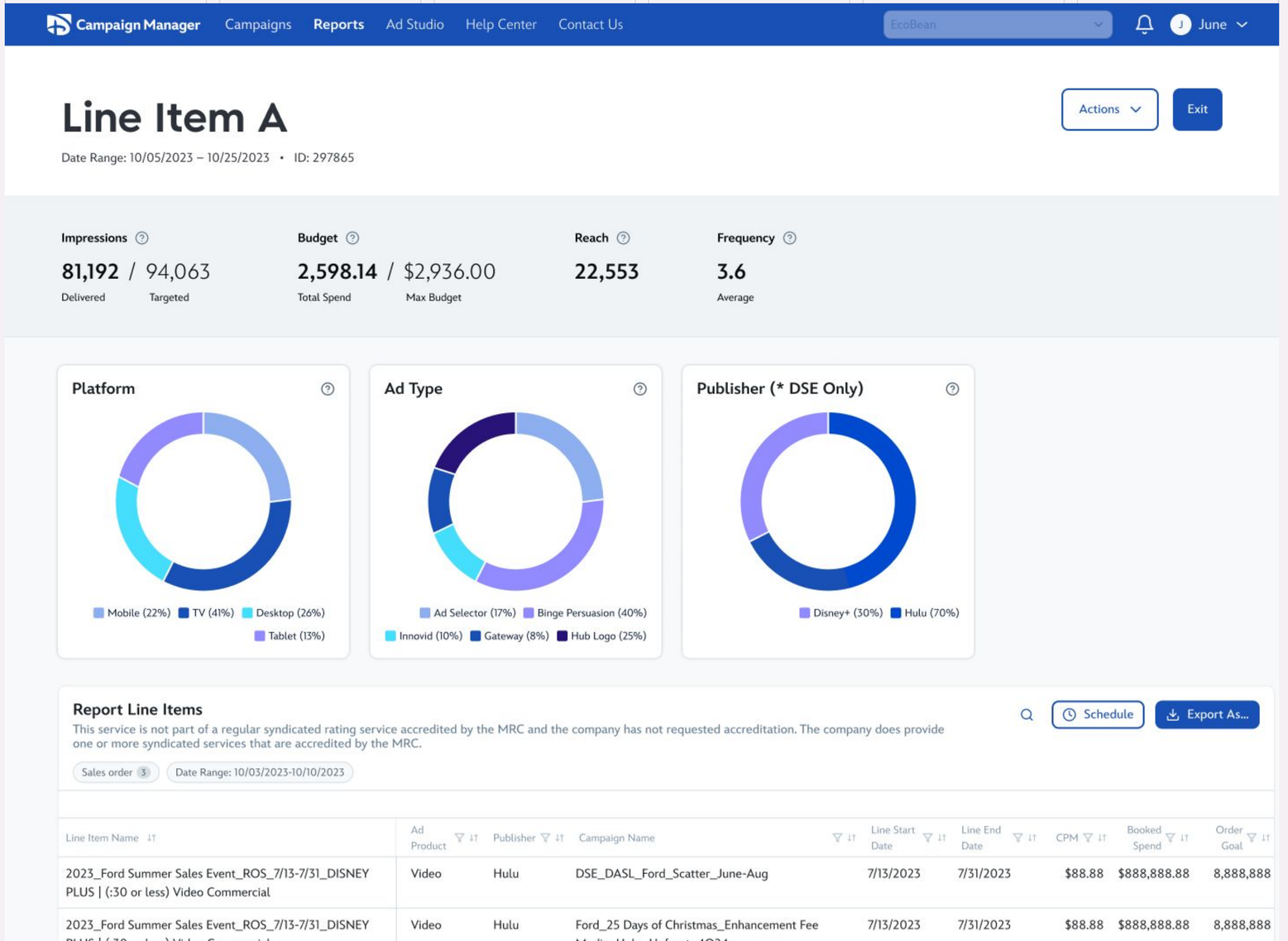
Existing Internal Reporting



Externalized Reporting

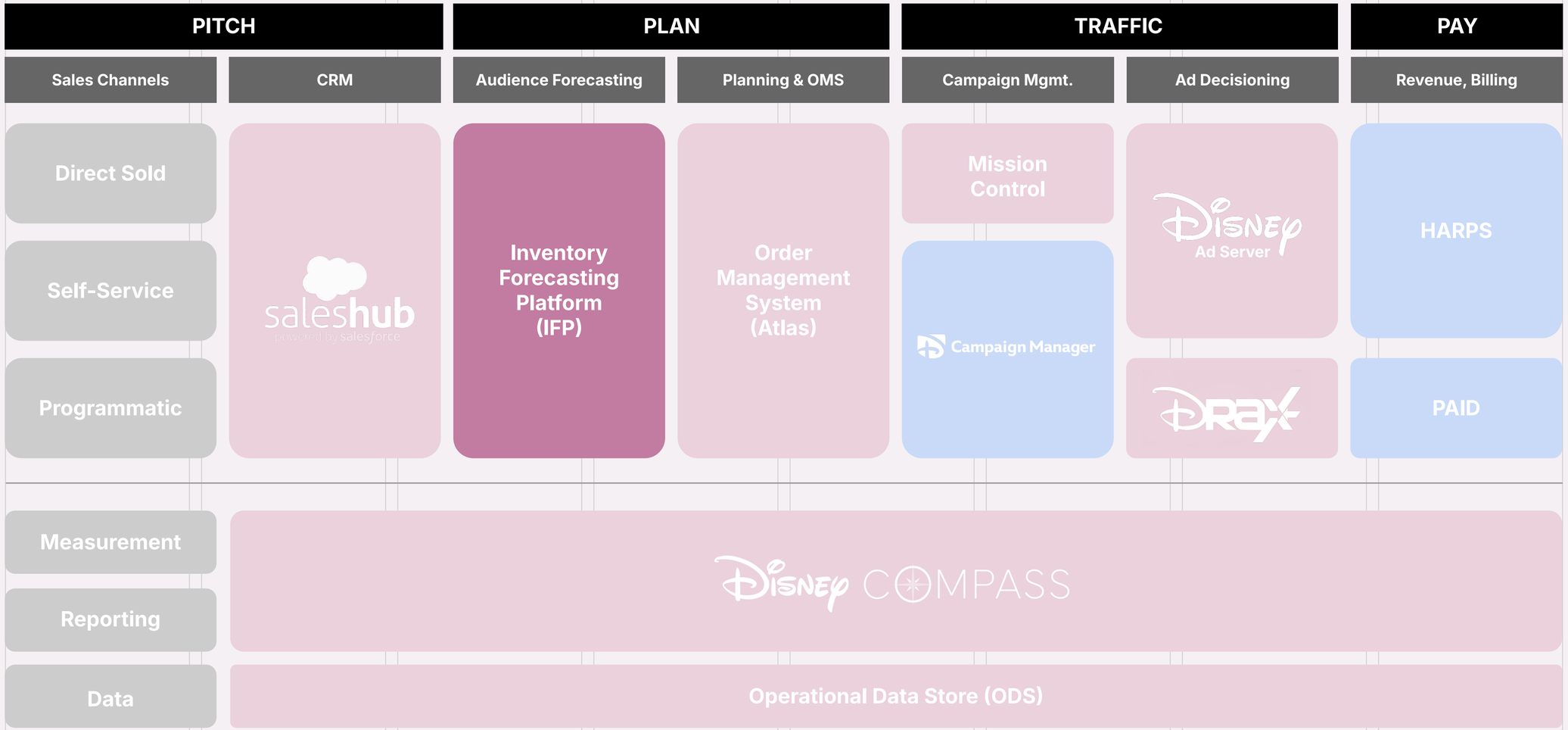


Externalized Reporting



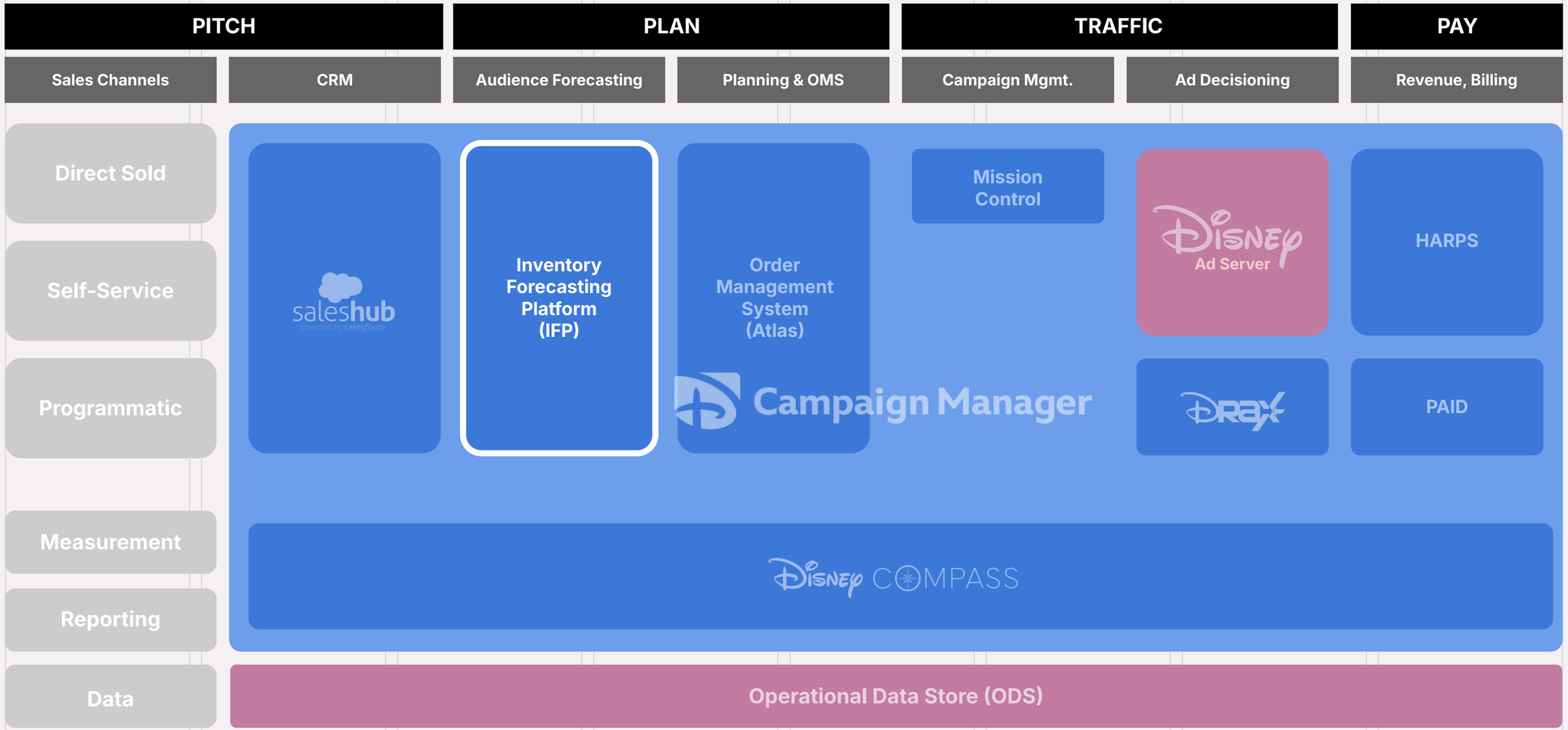
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External Tooling (Customer Facing)

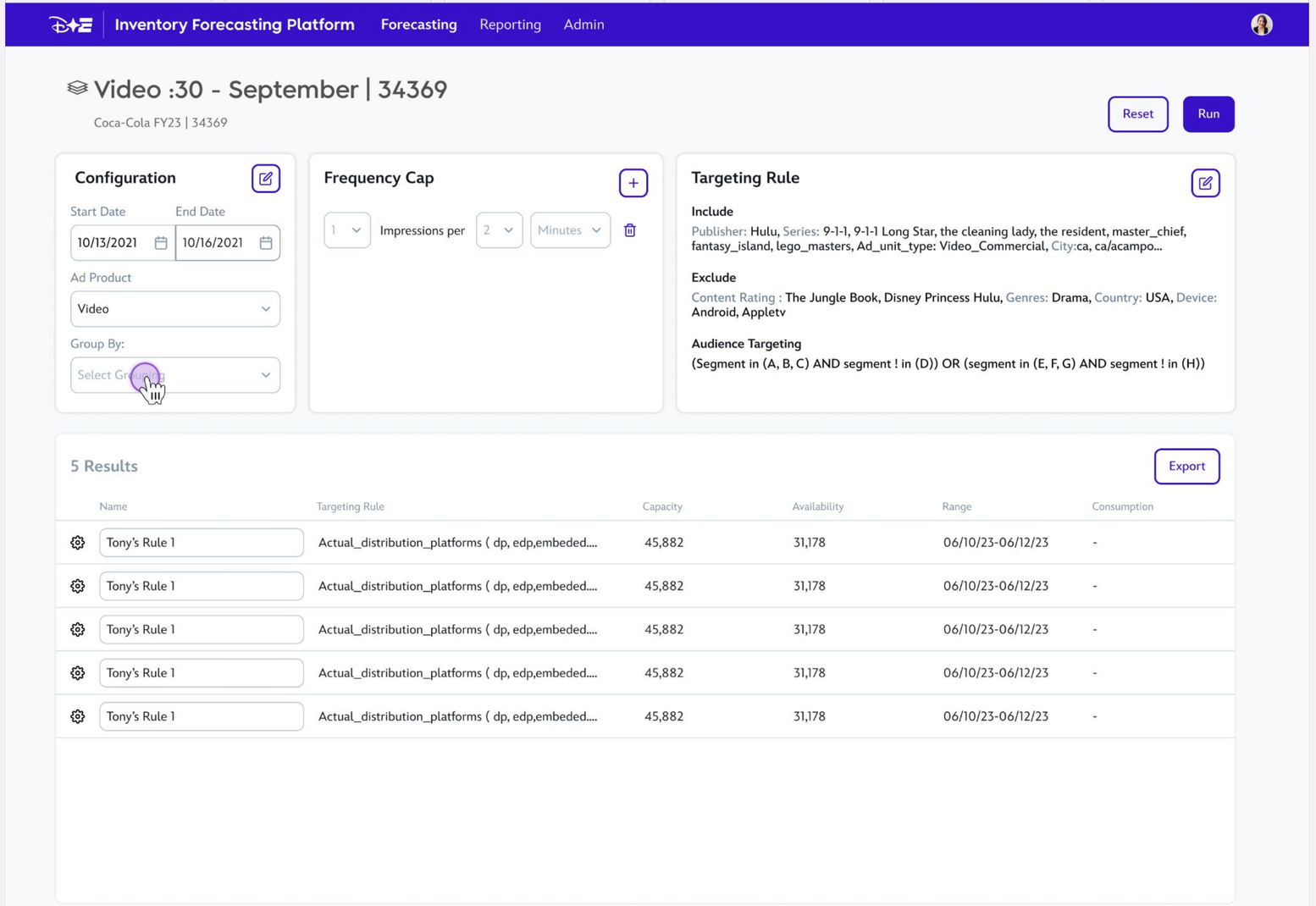


Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

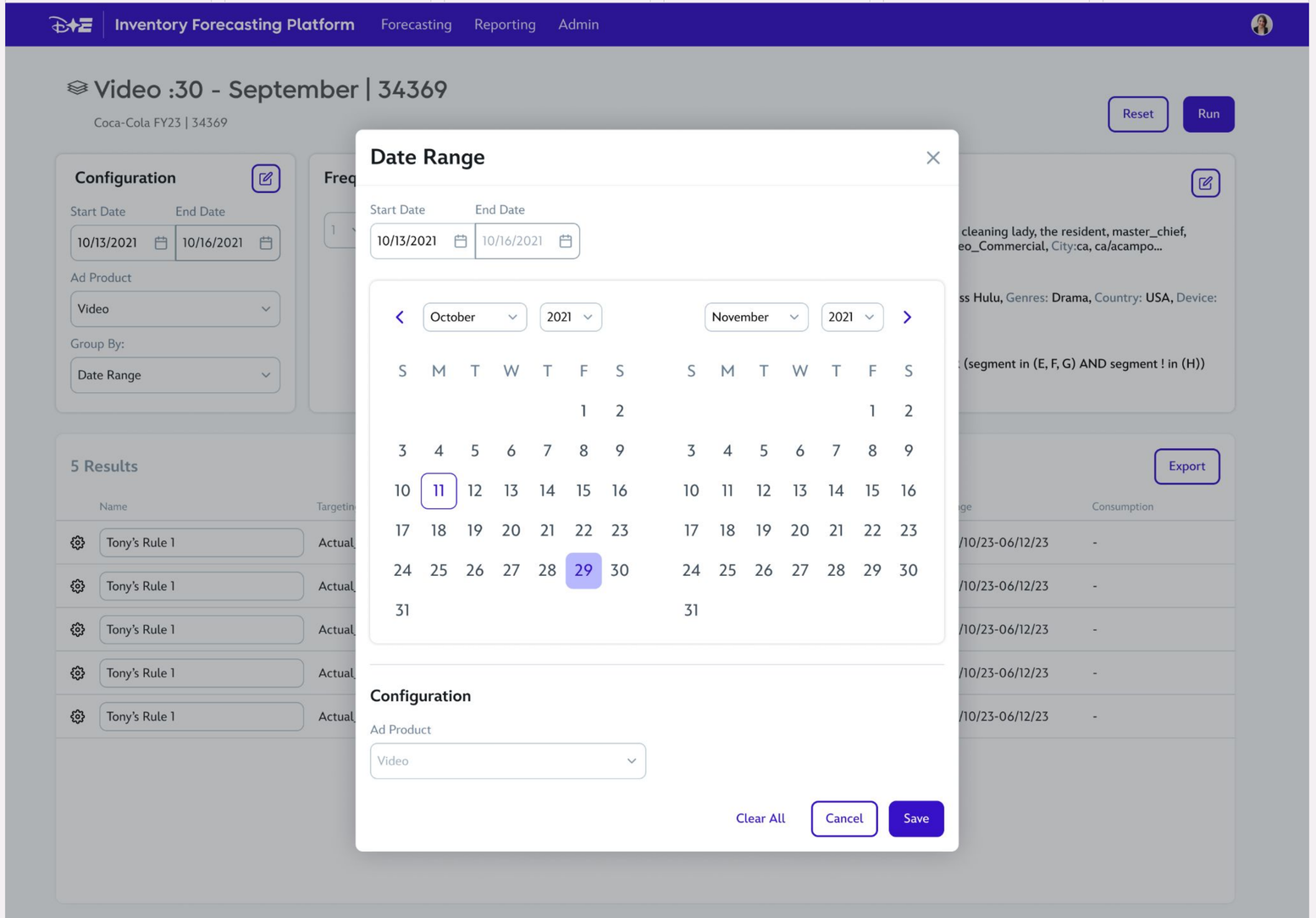
External Tooling (Customer Facing)



Existing Internal Content Selection



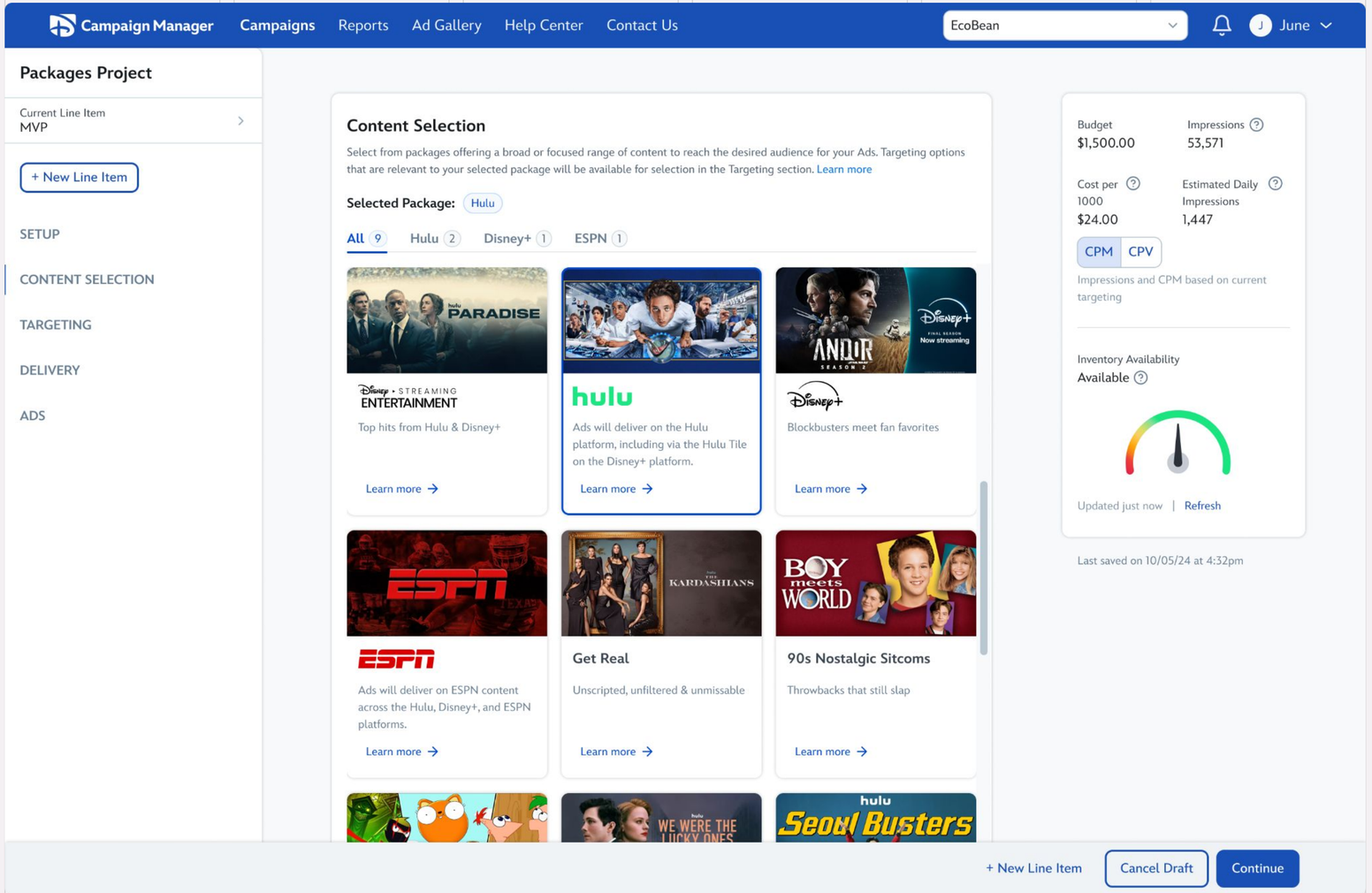
Existing Internal Content Selection



Externalizing Content Selection

Packages will unlock premium content bundles directly in DCM.

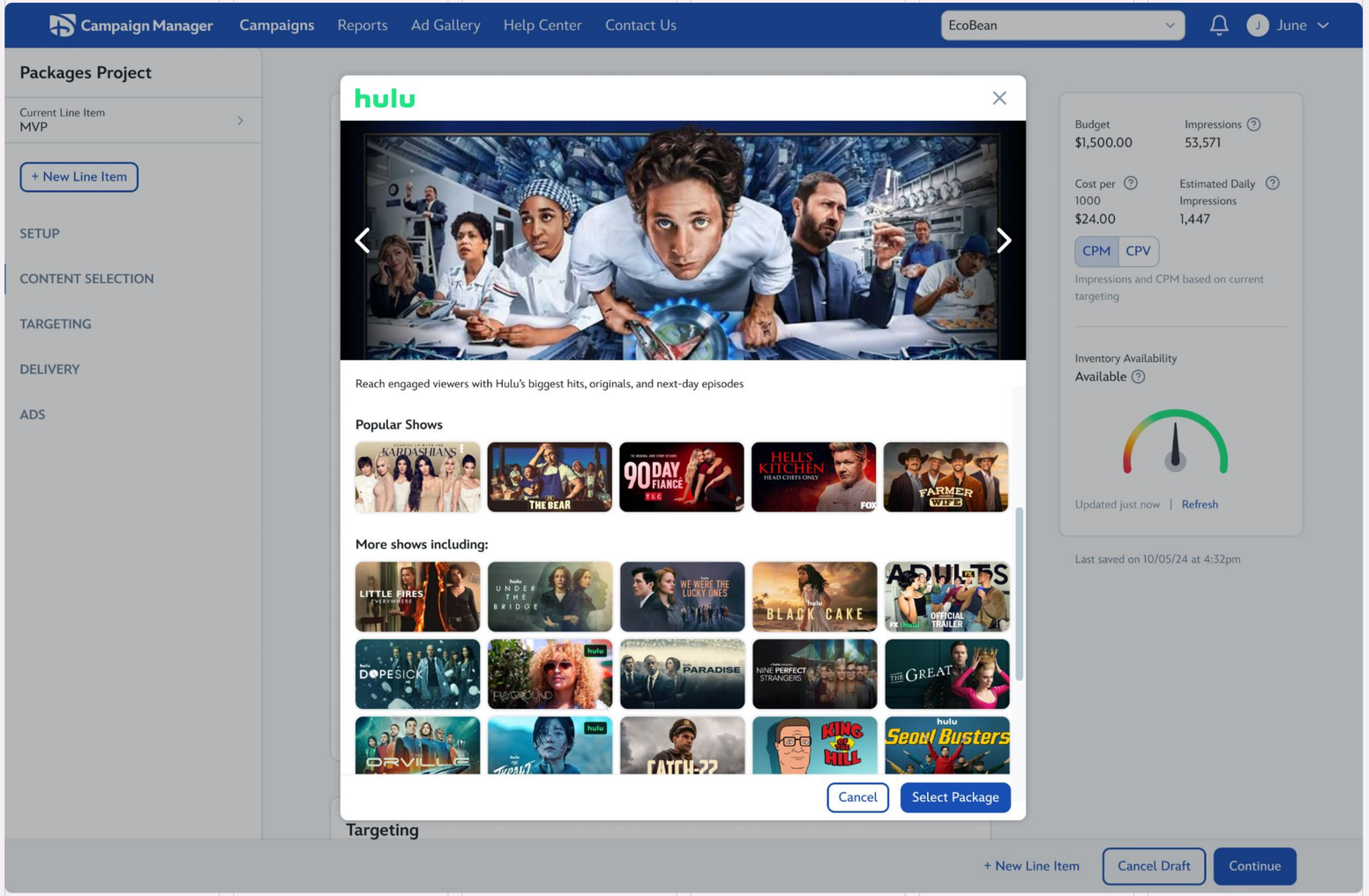
- Expands advertiser choice with curated collections (sports, seasonal, etc...).
- Allows advertisers to have a complete glimpse into our inventory
- More visual and easier to interact with



Externalizing Content Selection

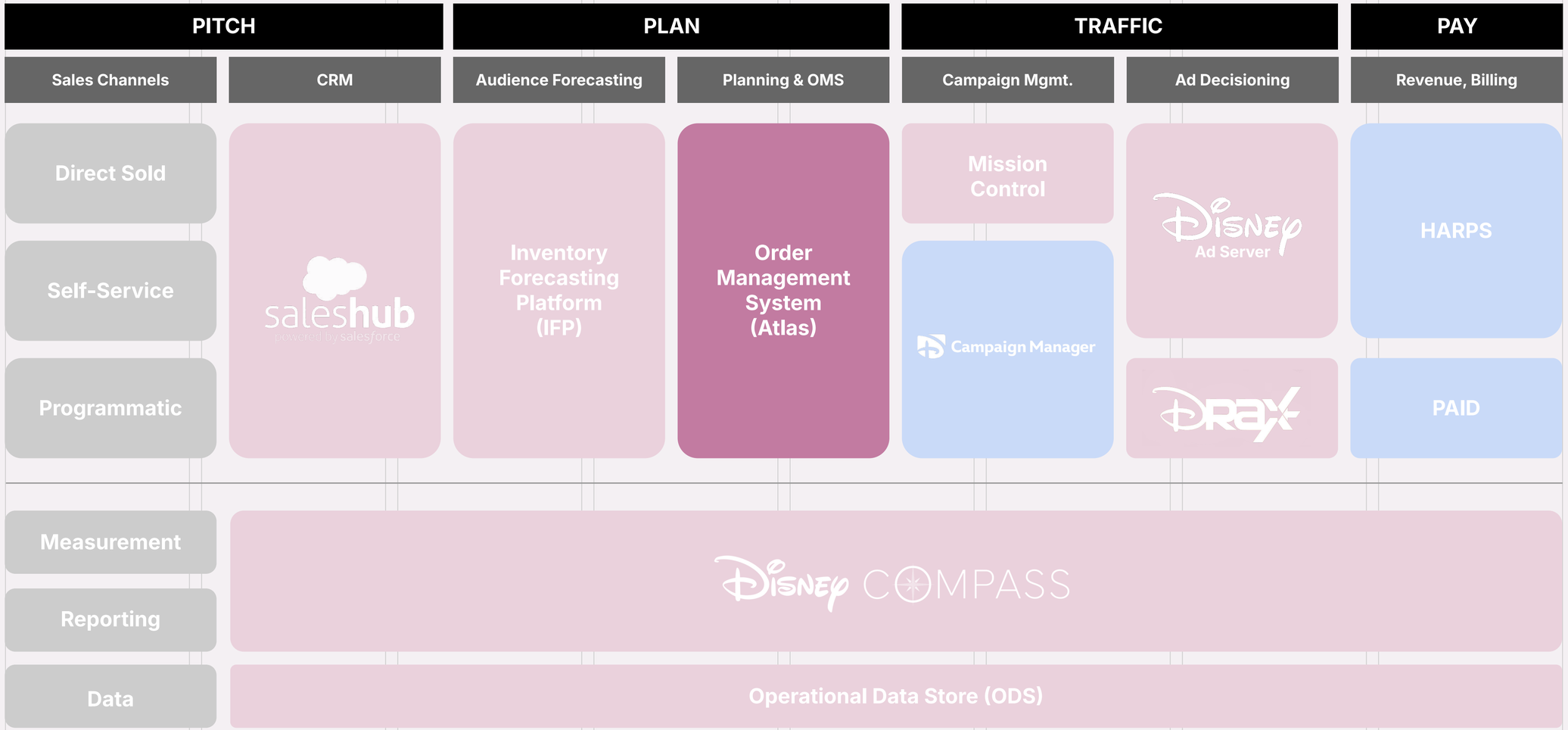
Packages will unlock premium content bundles directly in DCM.

- Expands advertiser choice with curated collections (sports, seasonal, etc...).
- Allows advertisers to have a complete glimpse into our inventory
- More visual and easier to interact with



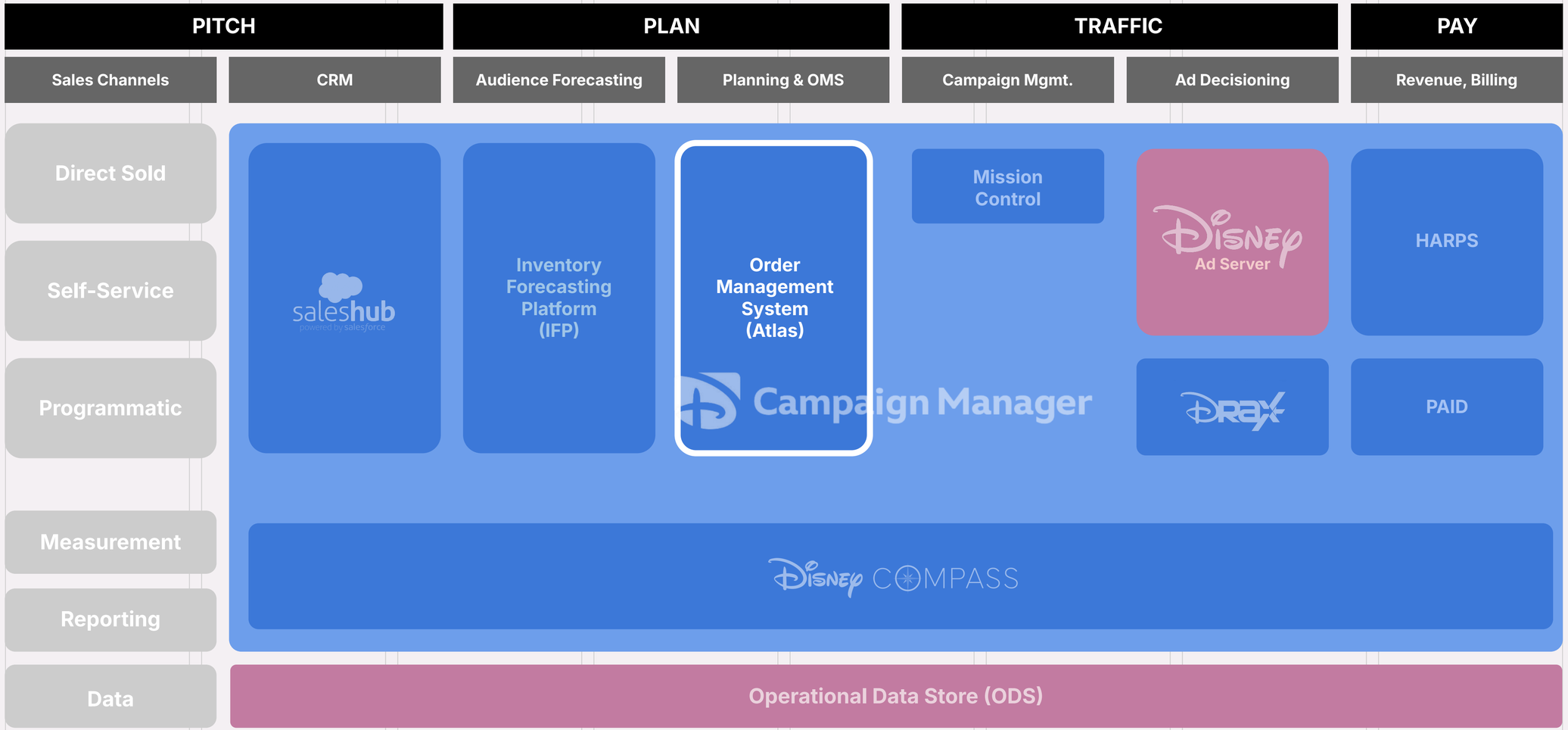
Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

External Tooling (Customer Facing)

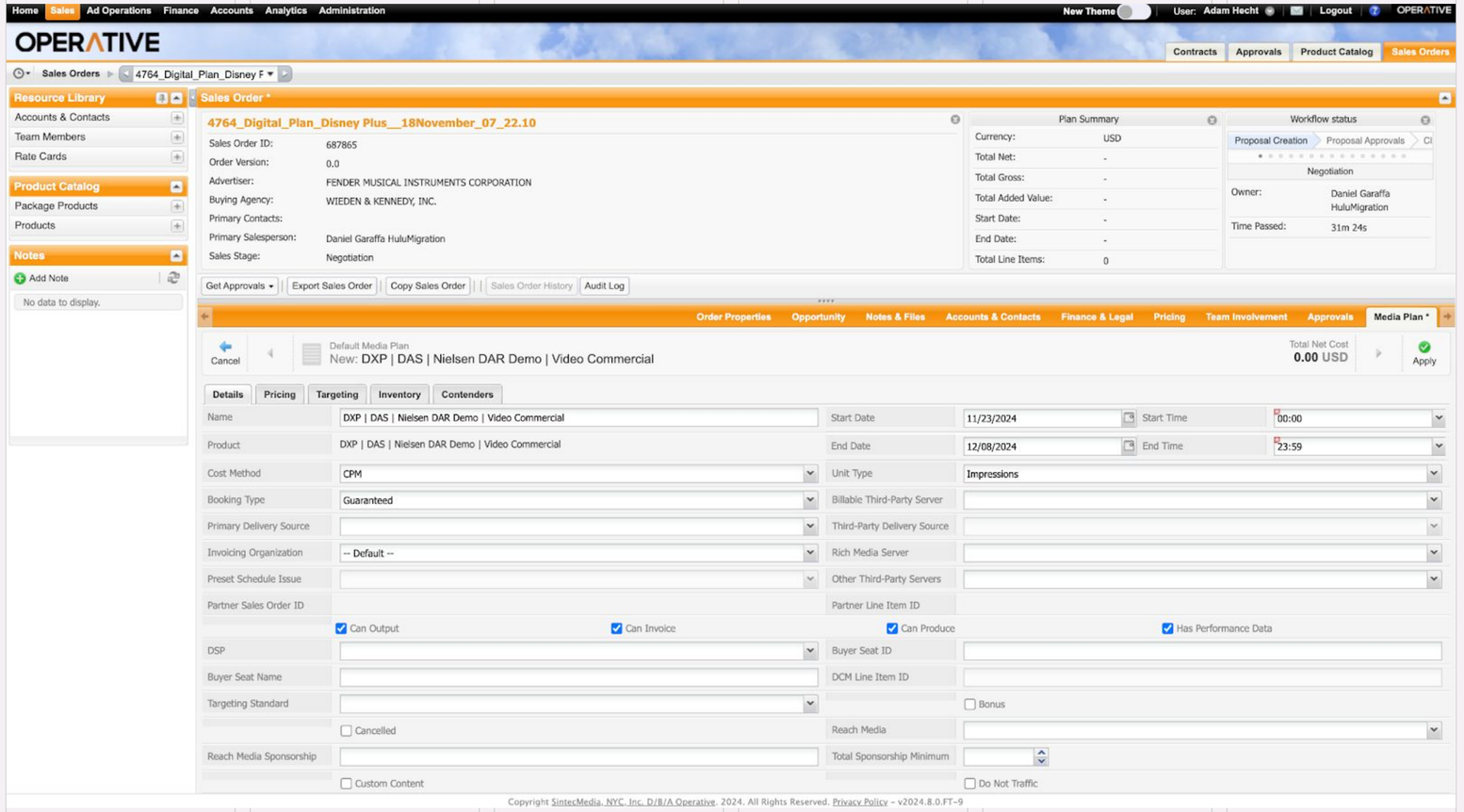


Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

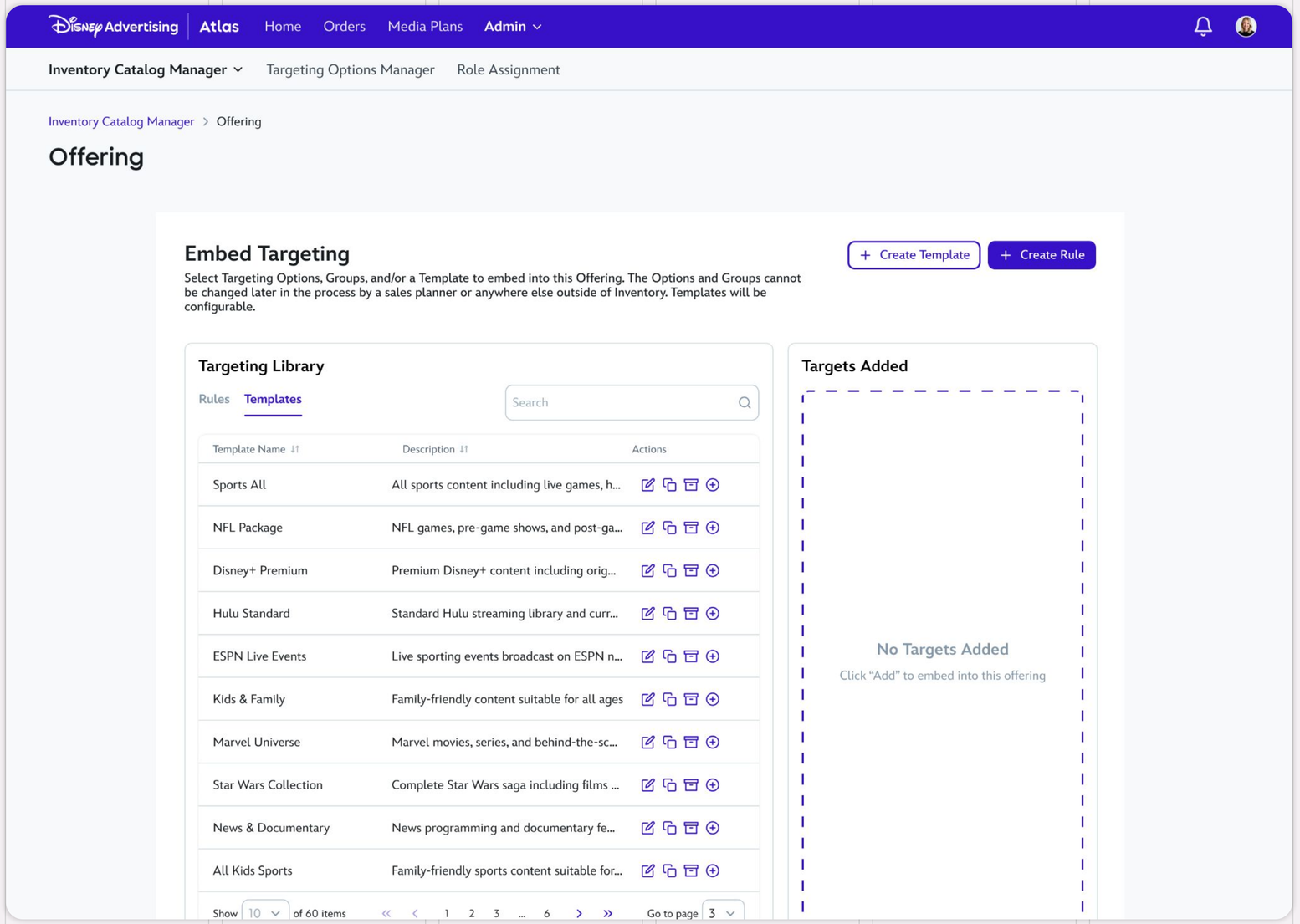
External Tooling (Customer Facing)



Current Internal Process

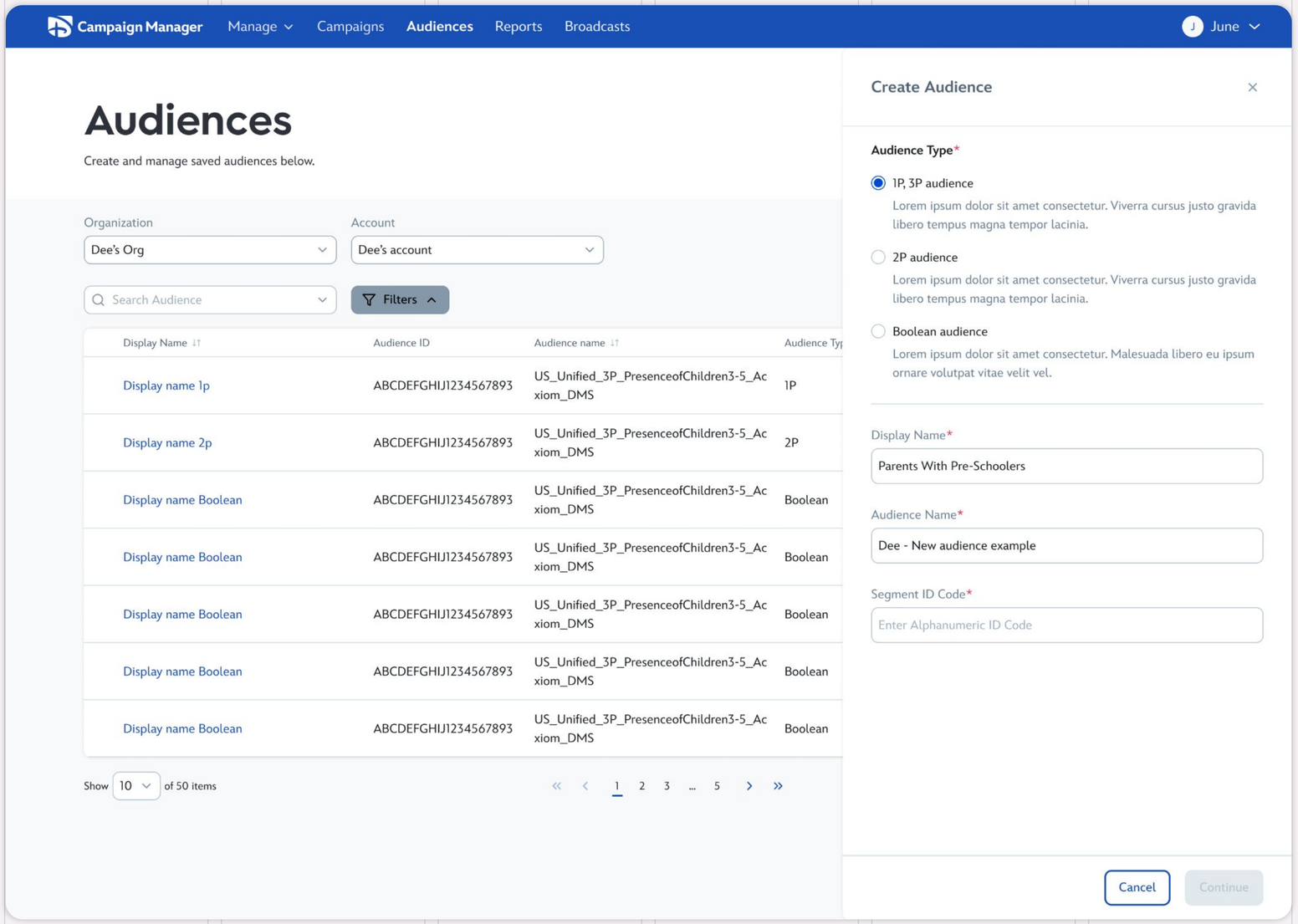


Interim Internal Redesign (Bringing in-house)



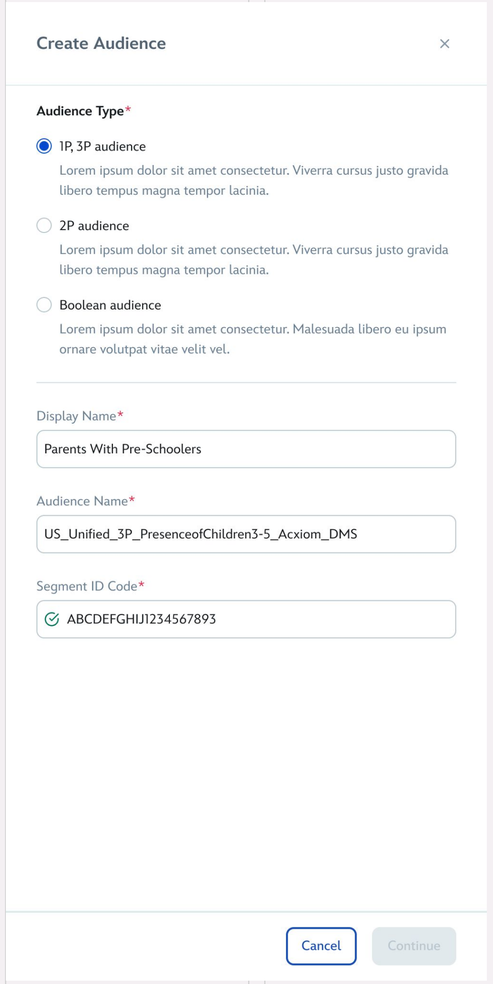
Long Term Externalized Audience Creation

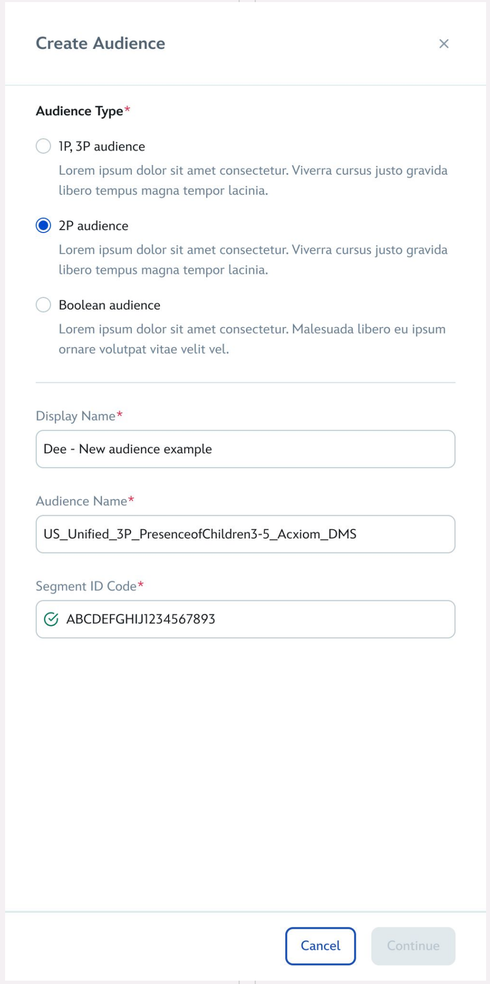
- To close the gap DCM introduces “Curated Audiences”.
- This enables Sellers to curate and push advanced audience segments to Advertisers, expanding targeting capabilities within Self-Serve.
- Once applied, advertisers can independently reuse these audiences across campaigns enabling scale, efficiency, and long-term transition toward full self-service.

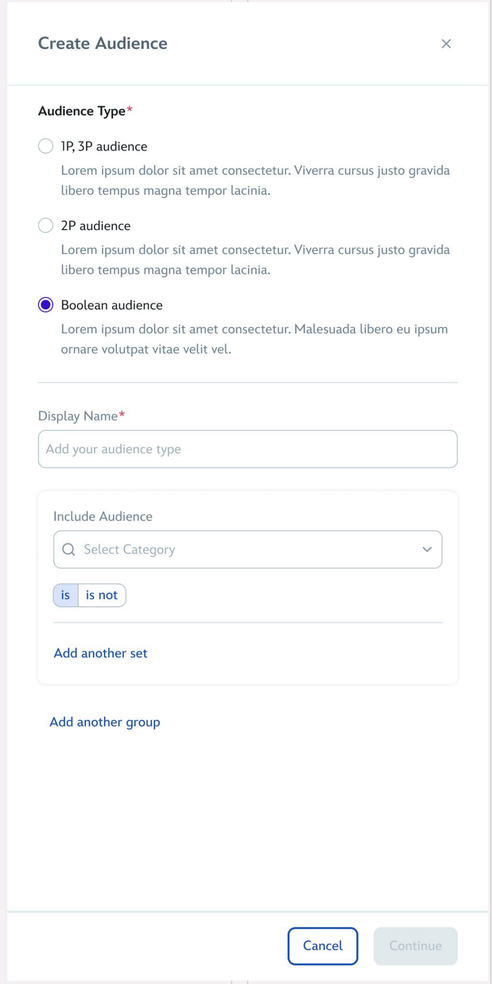


Long Term Externalized Audience Creation

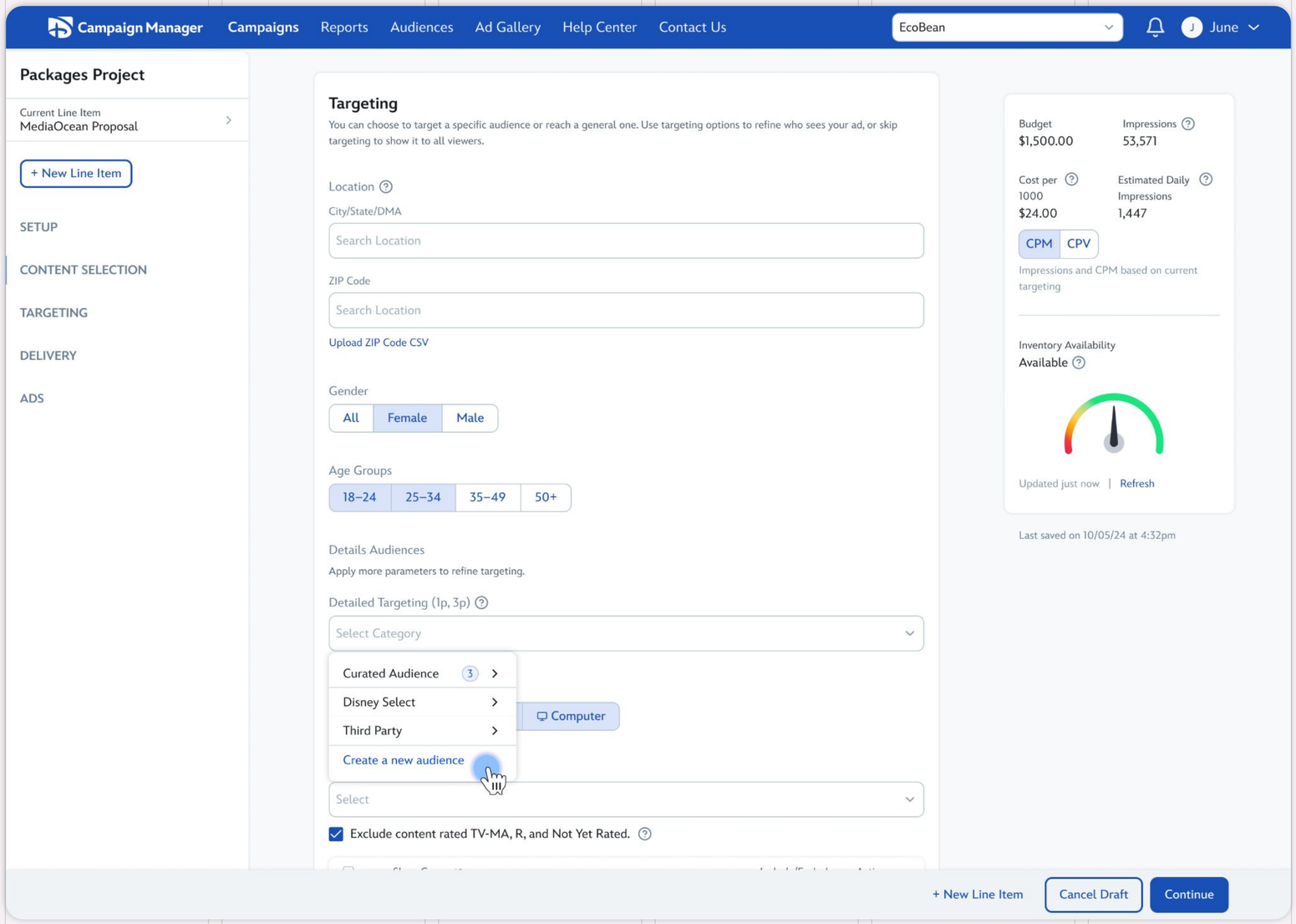
- 1P: Sellers use Disney data
- 3P: Liveramp and Sellers use external data mapped to Disney data to create audiences
- 2P: Advertiser and Seller use advertiser data mapped to Disney data to create audiences
- Boolean: existing 1P and 3P audiences are combined together using AND/OR logic to create a new audience segment.



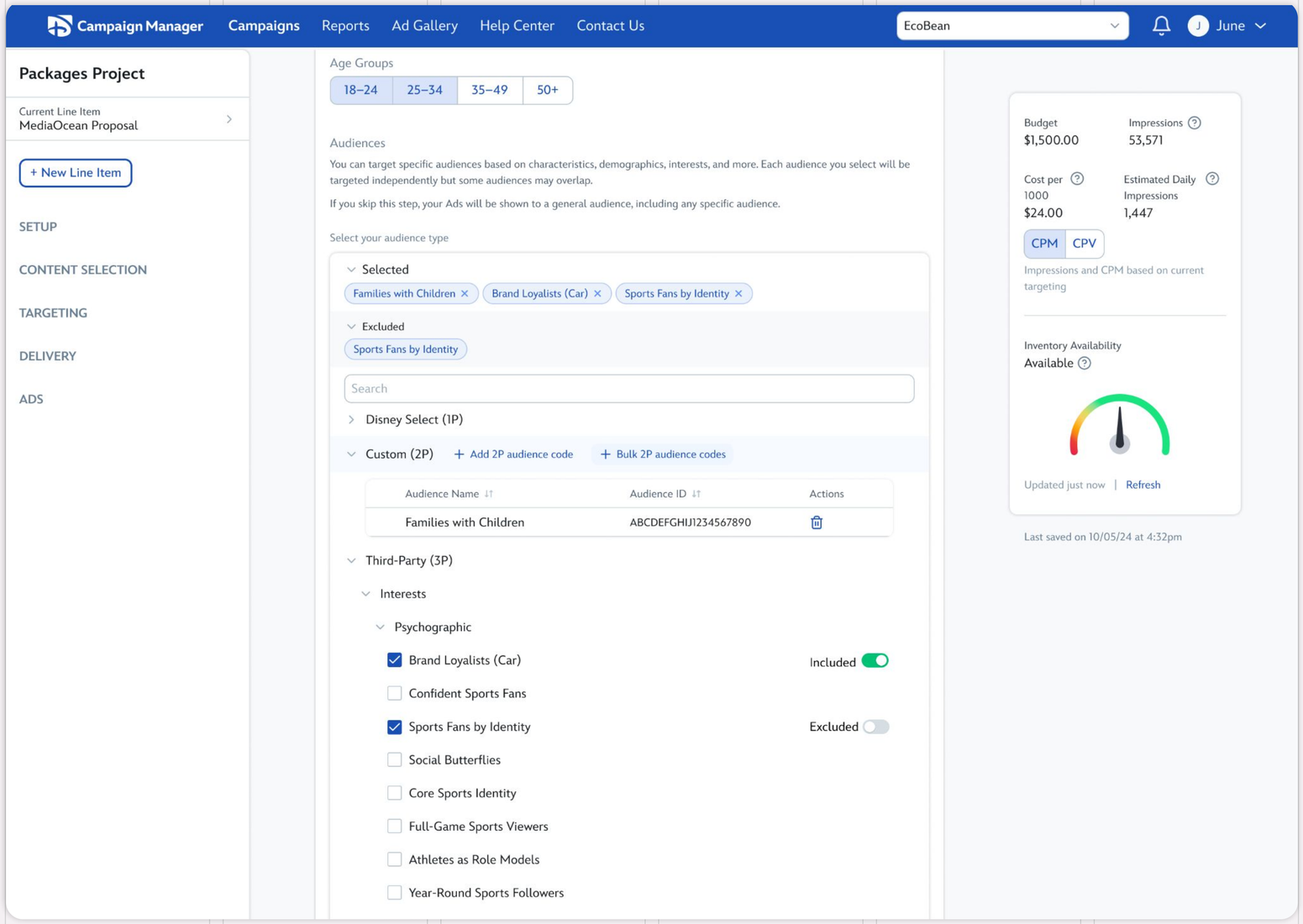




Long Term Externalized Audience Creation

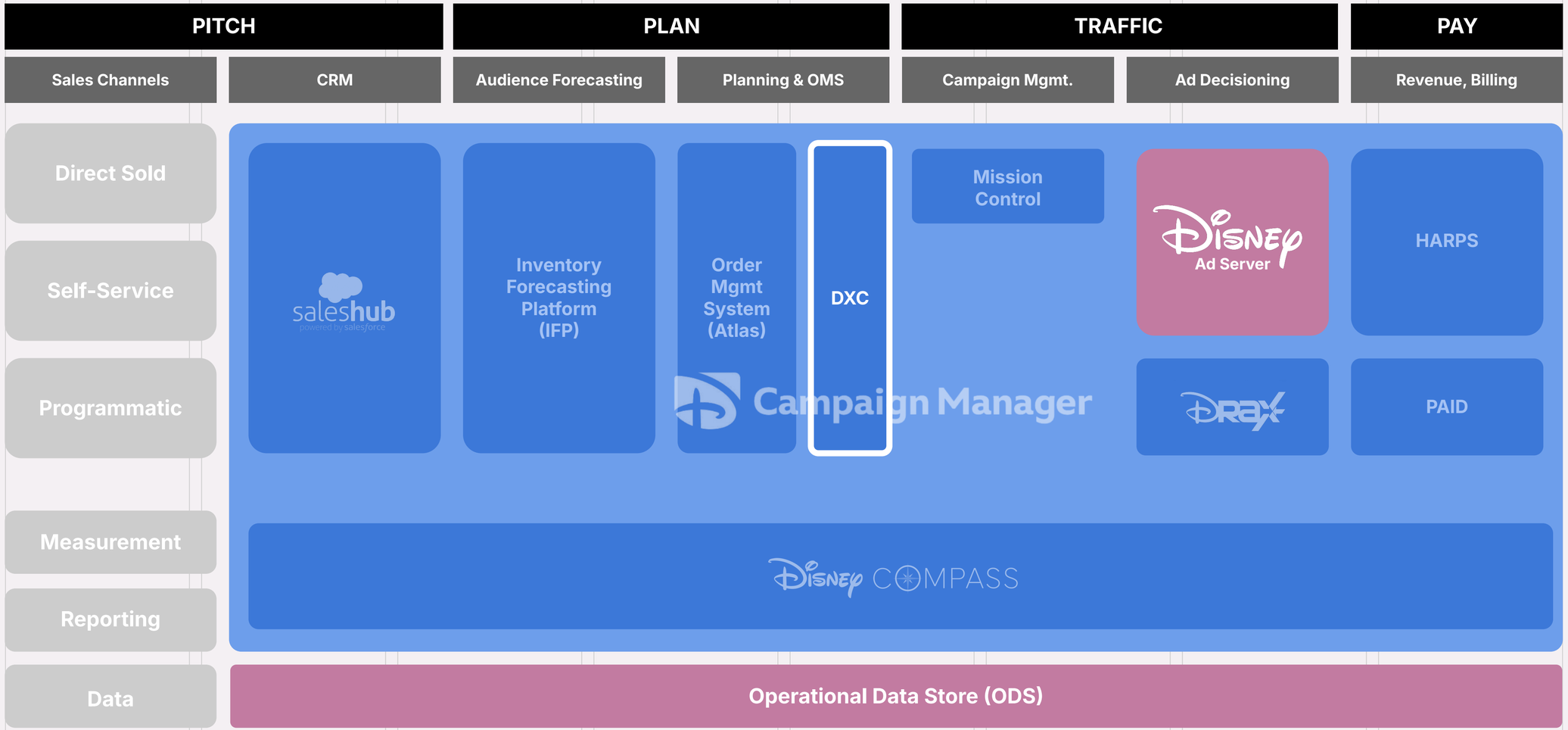


Long Term Externalized Audience Creation



Enterprise Tooling (Disney Internal Facing)

External Tooling (Customer Facing)



Competition’s Ad Creation Tools

Most major streaming platforms lack self-serve, web-based ad creation tools. There is a gap for true creativity and customization in interactive ads.

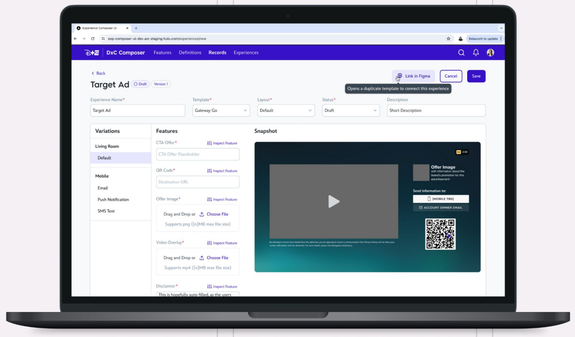
Our competitors have interactive ads, but their means of creation, customization, and delivery fall short.

Platform	Web-Based Ad Creative Tool	Interactive Ad Formats Supported	Where it Falls Short
Youtube	✓ Yes (Video Builder)	✓ End screens, shoppable, CTAs	✗ Template-based only, no branching logic or rich interactivity
Peacock	✗ No	✓ Shoppable, pause, overlay ads	✗ No external creative tool; relies on internal teams or external agencies
Prime Video	✓ Amazon Video Builder	✓ Fire TV Interactive ads	✗ Builder only for static videos; interactive ads built in-house
Max (HBO)	✗ No	✓ One-click reveal, carousel, extendable, locator	✗ No self-serve creative tool; interactive units agency-built
Paramount+	✓ Yes (via Waymark, Spaceback)	− Pause Ads, branded slates	✗ Tools support basic video creation; limited interactivity
Netflix	✗ No	− Interactive ads in development	✗ No creative tooling; infrastructure still evolving

Unlock Premium Ad Experiences for Advertisers at Scale

CREATE & ASSEMBLE → **TEST & PREVIEW** → **DEPLOY & MEASURE**

DXC Composer



Accelerate Deployment: Minimize Friction, Lower Costs, and Speed Time to Market

Testing Platform

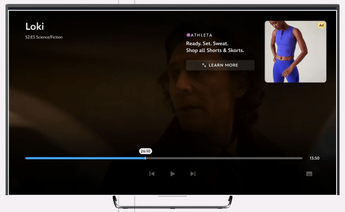


Streamline Approvals with External Feedback: Test and Preview Ad Creatives Seamlessly

Formats w/ Interactivity



Interactive+



Pause+



Choice+



Video+

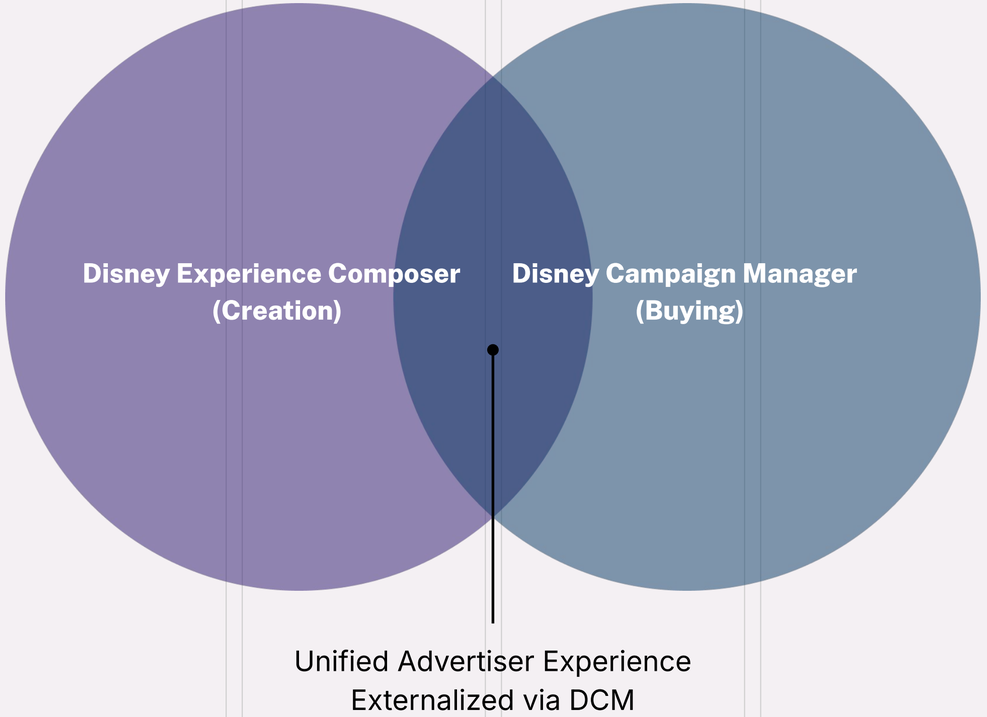
Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

Unifying creation and buying unlocks new value.

Integrating DXC creation into DCM bridges the gap between building and buying.

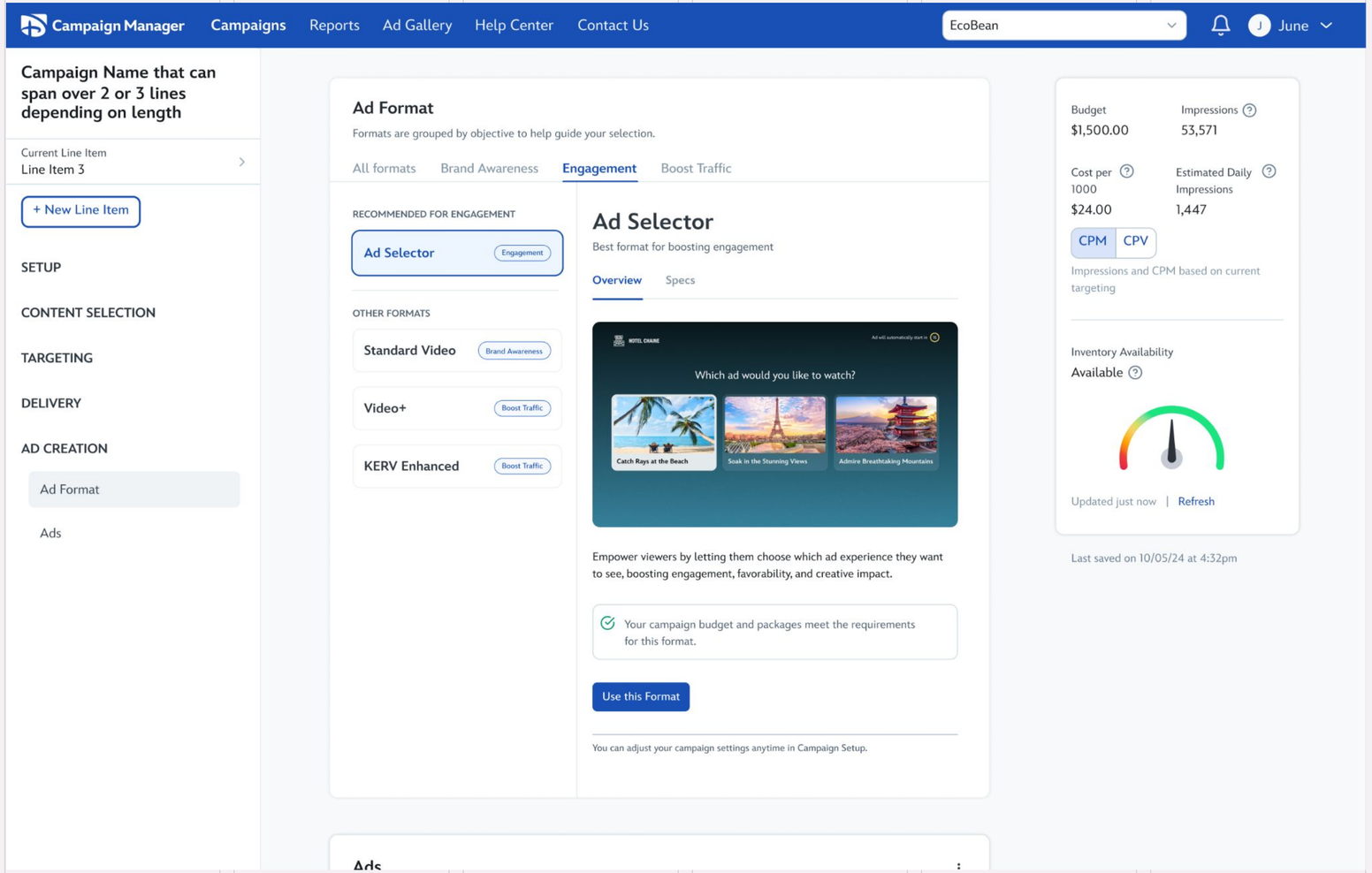
How it ladders into OKRs:

- **Be CTV's Highest Yield Platform** - expands premium ad opportunities.
- **Be the Easiest Buying Platform to Transact With** - simplify workflows through unified creation and buying.
- **Generate Greater Value for Advertisers** - enable self-serve access and faster campaign setup.



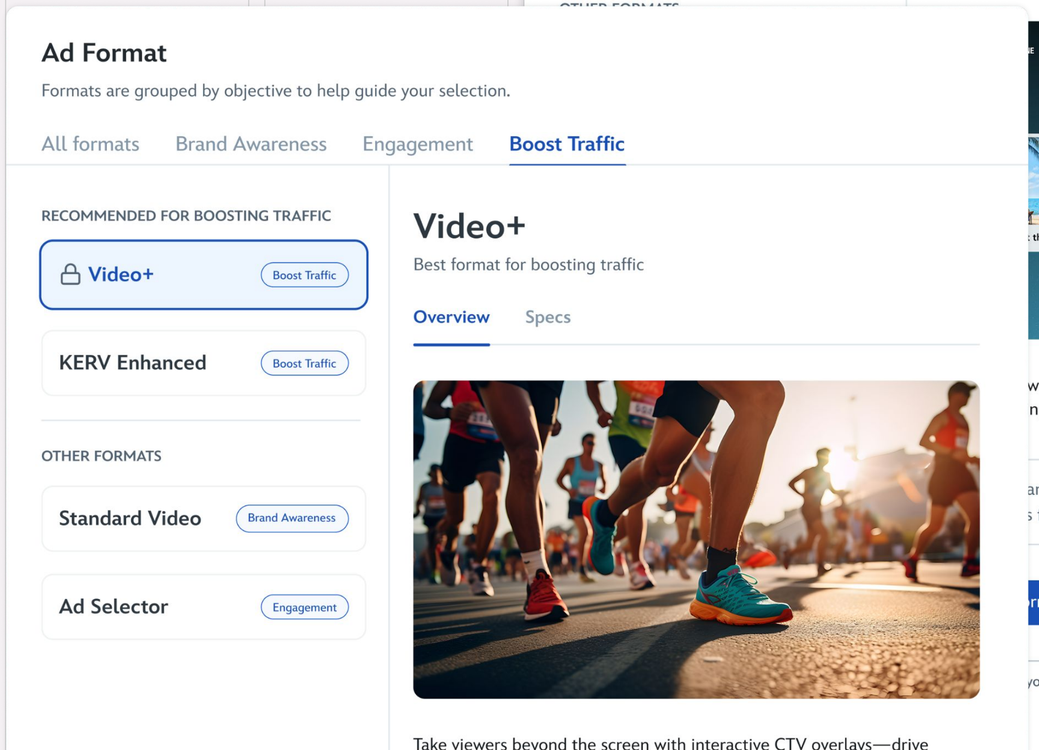
Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

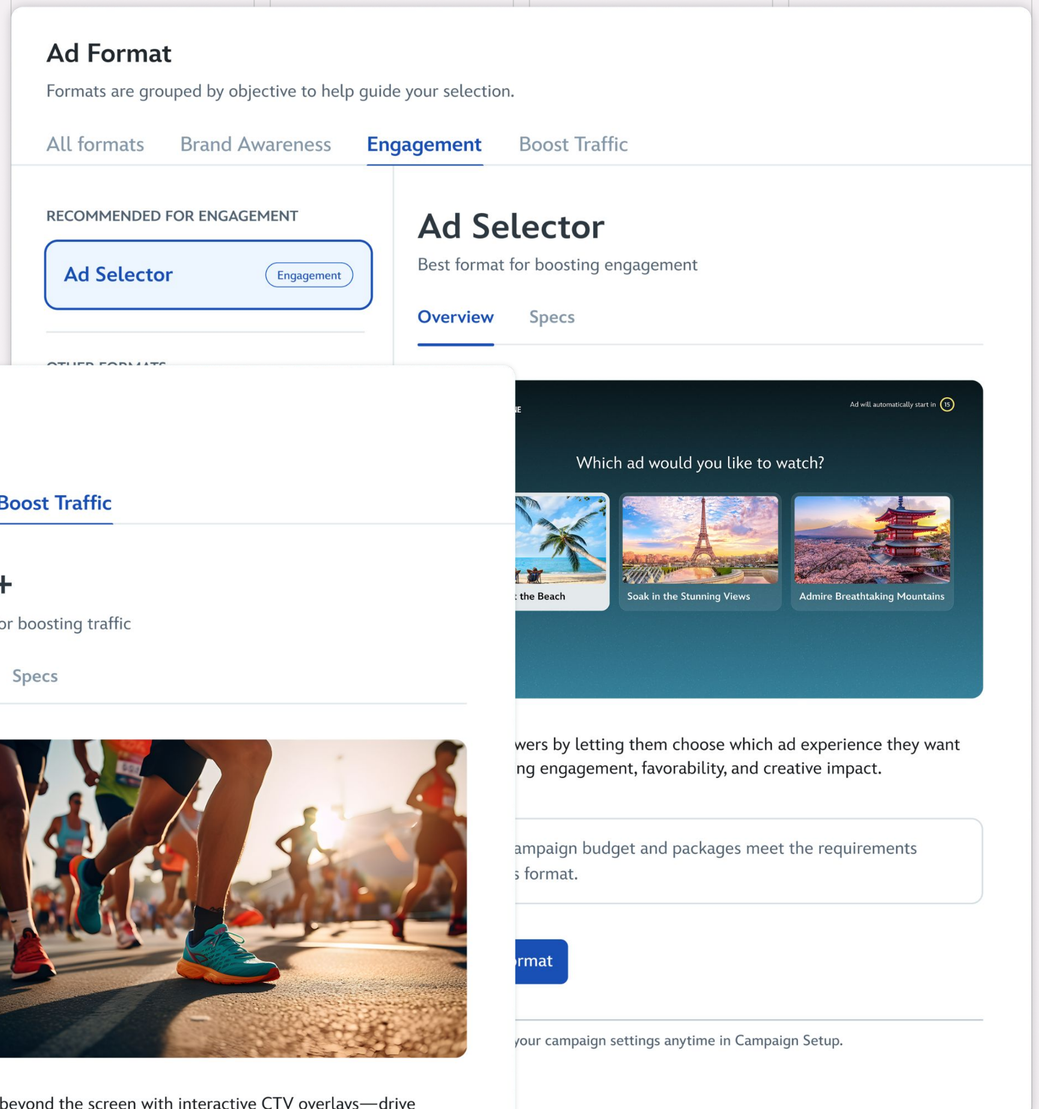
- DXC = Disney eXperience Composer
- Enable all advertisers to access premium ad formats directly in DCM by removing operational overhead and leveraging DXC for self-serve ad creation.



Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

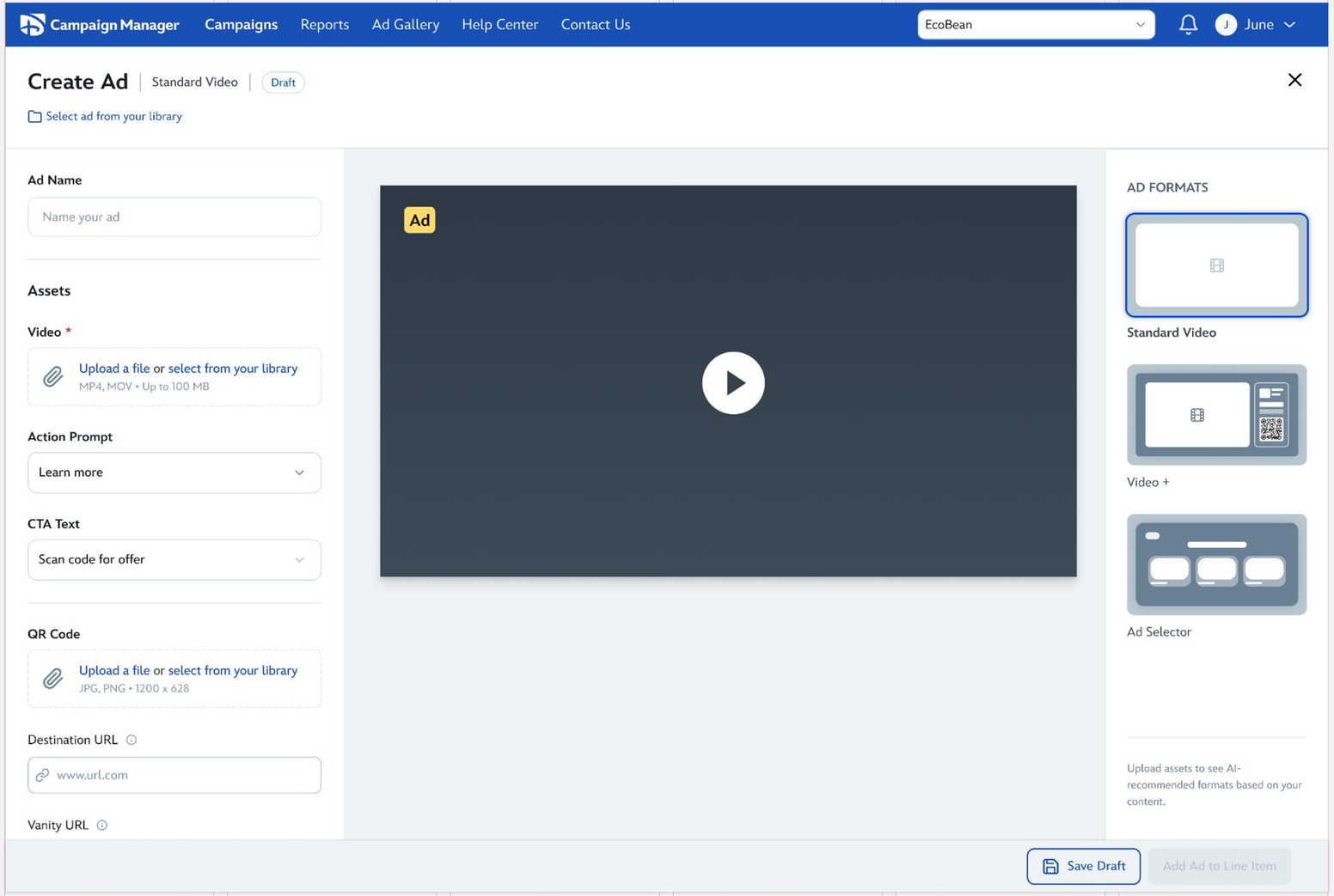
- Ad formats are organized by campaign objective to help advertisers explore available options, understand requirements and eligibility, and decide whether a format is right for their campaign.





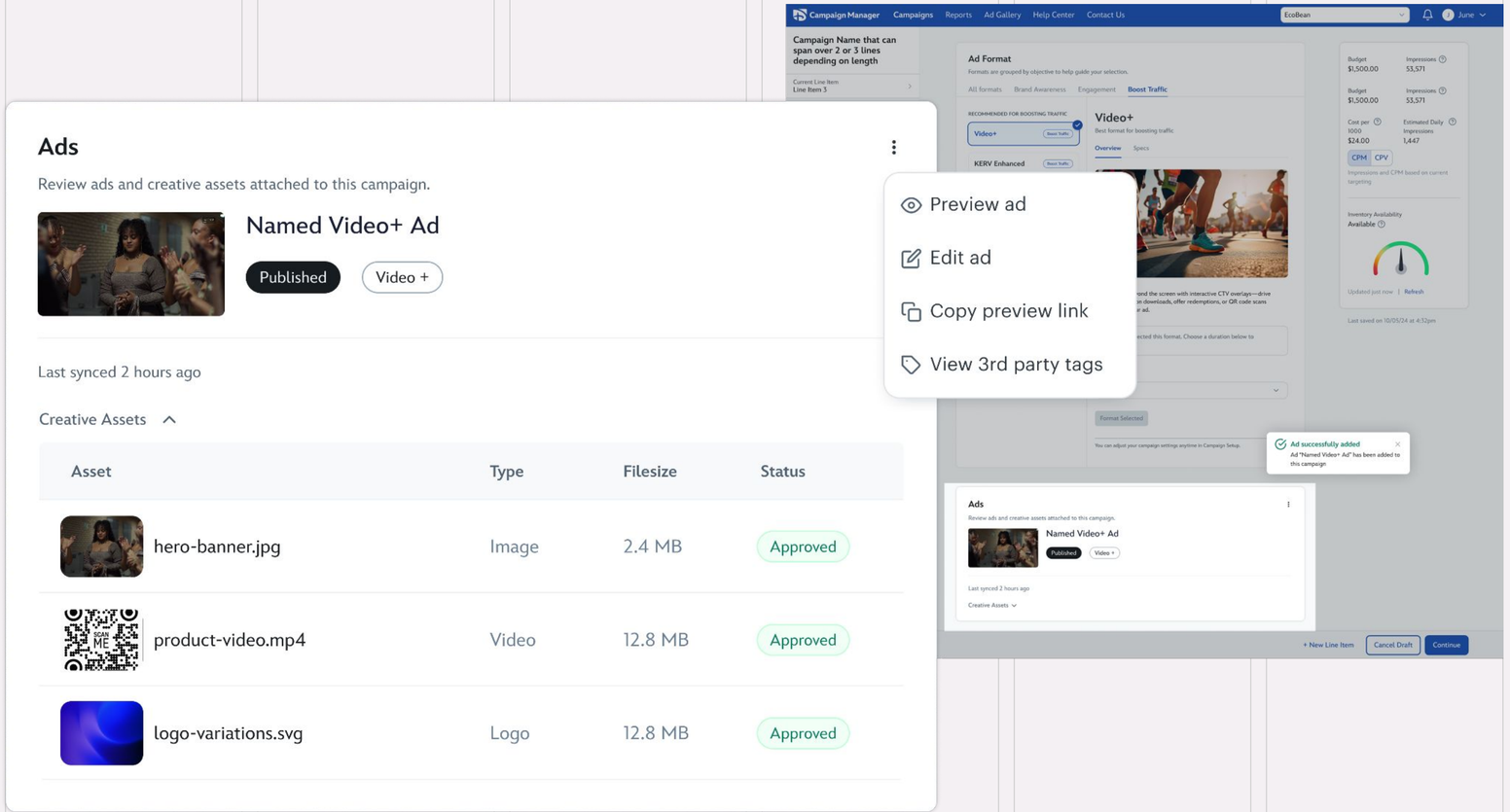
Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

- Ad creation happens directly within campaign setup, allowing advertisers to upload assets, customize creative, and preview in real time without leaving the flow.



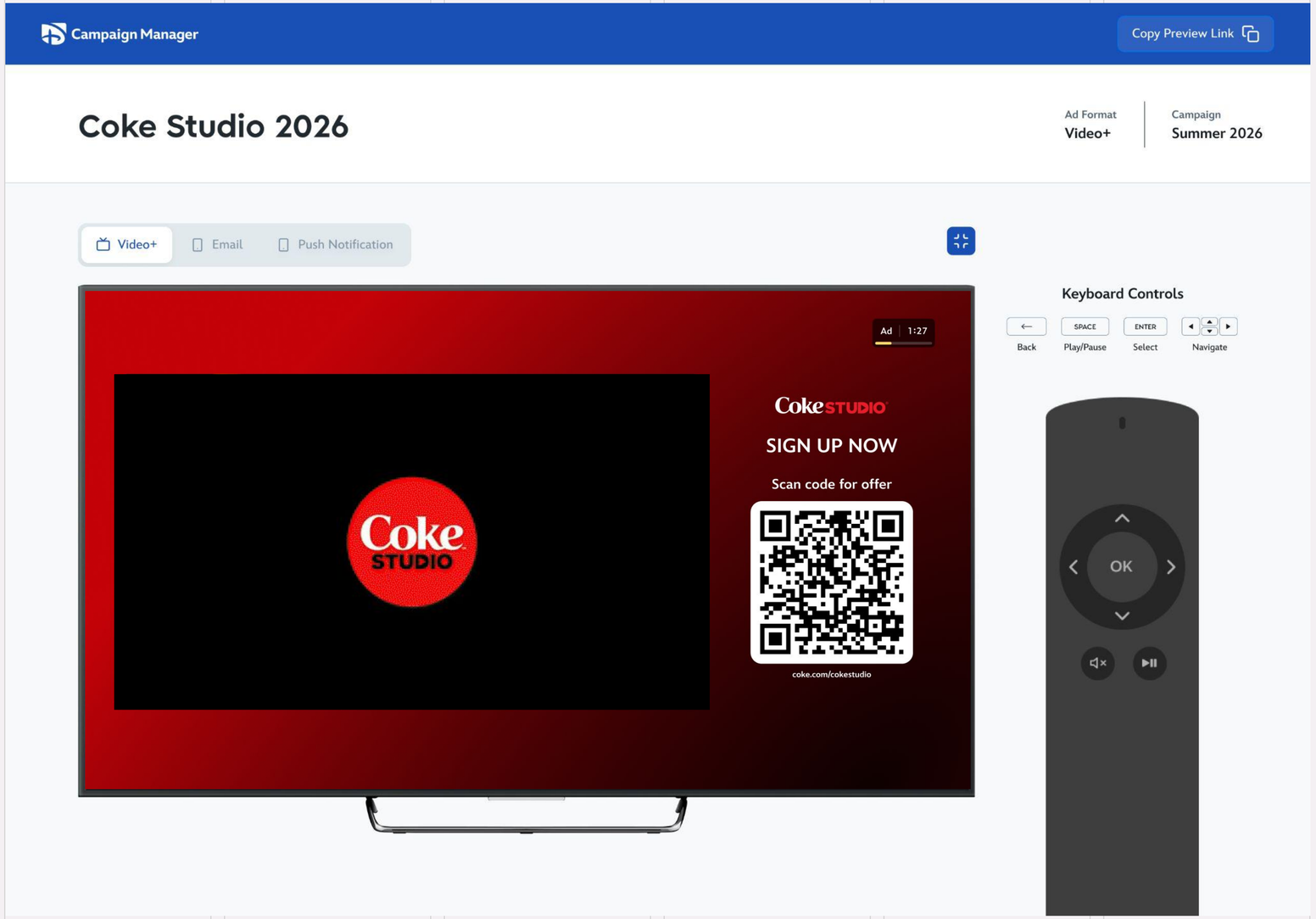
Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

- After creation, ads and associated assets are surfaced within the campaign flow for review, validation, and iteration before launch.



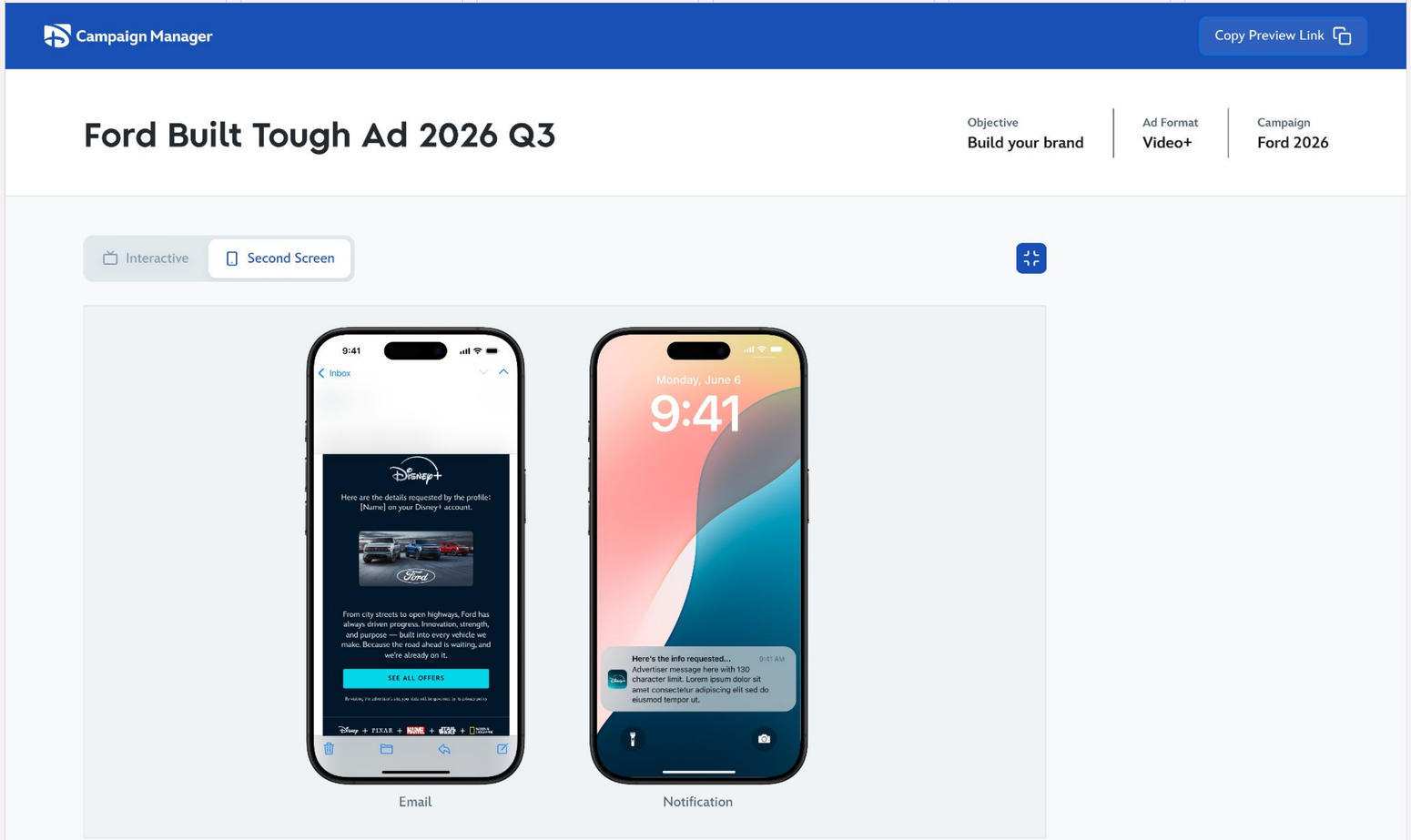
Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

- Users can preview their rendered experience (in all forms: interactive, second screen, etc.) Public link that can be sent to advertisers for review.



Externalizing Ad Creation Tools

- Users can preview their rendered experience (in all forms: interactive, second screen, etc.) Public link that can be sent to advertisers for review.



Executive Leadership OKRs

Be CTV's Highest Yield Platform

Generate 5% revenue lift in Q1 FY26

+4.1% lift

Actuals as of Fri, Feb 13

Be the Easiest Buying Platform to Transact With

Reduce avg time to launch a campaign from request to activation by 20% in Q1 FY26

52% reduction

Actuals as of Fri, Feb 13

Generate the Industry's Greatest Value for Advertisers

High CPM + sustained demand = high performance

$45+ cpm

Actuals as of Fri, Feb 13

Why Netflix?

I’ve spent years scaling complex platforms at Disney. I’m excited to apply my systems thinking in a real-time, consumer-facing ecosystem.

My super power is upleveling design craft and quality.

I know how to translate vision into roadmaps, rituals, and shipped outcomes.

I’ve grown designers into leaders and hand-selected teams that consistently raise the bar.

This feels like the right inflection point for me to expand my impact beyond Disney.

Thank You!

NETFLIX

Tomorrow: What is Design's actual role in the product development cycle?

